

# THE 200-RECIPE KITCHEN

A COMPREHENSIVE COOKBOOK FOR EVERYDAY COOKING

Two hundred distinct recipes across breakfast, soups, salads, pasta, grains, vegetarian and vegan mains, poultry, meat, seafood, global one-pots, breads, savory baking, appetizers, sauces, cakes, cookies, desserts, drinks, and frozen treats.

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

- Each recipe gives practical prep and cook times, servings, ingredients, step-by-step method, storage guidance, swaps, and a cook's tip.
- Measurements are written in familiar home-kitchen units. Ovens use Fahrenheit. Meat and poultry recipes include doneness guidance where relevant.
- Treat salt, acidity, spice, and garnish as adjustable finishing tools; taste as you cook.

# CONTENTS

Every section contains 10 recipes.

|    |                                          |         |
|----|------------------------------------------|---------|
| 01 | <b>Breakfast &amp; Brunch</b>            | page 4  |
| 02 | <b>Soups &amp; Stews</b>                 | page 14 |
| 03 | <b>Salads &amp; Fresh Bowls</b>          | page 24 |
| 04 | <b>Sandwiches, Wraps &amp; Handhelds</b> | page 34 |
| 05 | <b>Pasta &amp; Noodles</b>               | page 44 |
| 06 | <b>Rice, Grains &amp; Bowls</b>          | page 54 |
| 07 | <b>Vegetarian Mains</b>                  | page 64 |
| 08 | <b>Vegan Favorites</b>                   | page 74 |
| 09 | <b>Chicken &amp; Turkey</b>              | page 84 |
| 10 | <b>Beef, Pork &amp; Lamb</b>             | page 94 |

# CONTENTS, CONTINUED

Every section contains 10 recipes.

|           |                                              |          |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>11</b> | <b>Seafood</b>                               | page 104 |
| <b>12</b> | <b>Curries &amp; Global One-Pots</b>         | page 114 |
| <b>13</b> | <b>Breads &amp; Breakfast Baking</b>         | page 124 |
| <b>14</b> | <b>Pizzas &amp; Flatbreads</b>               | page 134 |
| <b>15</b> | <b>Snacks &amp; Appetizers</b>               | page 144 |
| <b>16</b> | <b>Sauces, Dips &amp; Condiments</b>         | page 154 |
| <b>17</b> | <b>Cakes &amp; Celebration Bakes</b>         | page 164 |
| <b>18</b> | <b>Cookies &amp; Bars</b>                    | page 174 |
| <b>19</b> | <b>Desserts &amp; Puddings</b>               | page 184 |
| <b>20</b> | <b>Drinks, Smoothies &amp; Frozen Treats</b> | page 194 |

# Blueberry Buttermilk Pancakes

*Fluffy pancakes with crisp edges, juicy berries, and a gentle tang from buttermilk.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
20 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- 2 tbsp sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1 1/4 cups vanilla extract
- 1 large egg
- 3 tbsp melted butter, plus more for the pan
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup maple syrup and extra berries
- buttermilk, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked pancakes up to 3 days or freeze 2 months.
- Swap: Use raspberries, chopped peaches, or chocolate chips instead of blueberries.
- Cook's tip: Do not overmix; a few lumps keep pancakes tender.

## METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt in a large bowl so the leavening is evenly distributed.
2. In a second bowl, whisk the vanilla extract, egg, melted butter, and vanilla extract until smooth. Pour the wet mixture into the dry ingredients.
3. Fold gently until only a few small streaks of flour remain, then fold in the maple syrup and extra berries. Rest the batter for 5 to 10 minutes; this gives the flour time to hydrate.
4. Heat a lightly buttered skillet or griddle over medium heat. The surface is ready when a drop of water sizzles and disappears quickly.
5. Cook portions of batter until bubbles form on top and the edges look set, then flip and cook until golden and cooked through.
6. Serve immediately with buttermilk. Keep finished batches warm on a rack in a low oven rather than stacking them, which can make them soggy.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Banana Walnut Pancakes

*Golden pancakes with mashed banana in the batter and toasted walnuts for crunch.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- 2 tbsp sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1 1/4 cups ground cinnamon
- 1 large egg
- 3 tbsp melted butter, plus more for the pan
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup sliced banana, yogurt, and maple syrup
- milk, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Freeze cooled waffles between sheets of parchment for up to 2 months.
- Swap: Use pecans or pumpkin seeds for the walnuts.
- Cook's tip: Re-crisp waffles in a toaster rather than a microwave.

## METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt in a large bowl so the leavening is evenly distributed.
2. In a second bowl, whisk the ground cinnamon, egg, melted butter, and vanilla extract until smooth. Pour the wet mixture into the dry ingredients.
3. Fold gently until only a few small streaks of flour remain, then fold in the sliced banana, yogurt, and maple syrup. Rest the batter for 5 to 10 minutes; this gives the flour time to hydrate.
4. Heat a lightly buttered skillet or griddle over medium heat. The surface is ready when a drop of water sizzles and disappears quickly.
5. Cook portions of batter until bubbles form on top and the edges look set, then flip and cook until golden and cooked through.
6. Serve immediately with milk. Keep finished batches warm on a rack in a low oven rather than stacking them, which can make them soggy.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Shakshuka

*Eggs gently poached in a spiced tomato and pepper sauce, finished with feta and herbs.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 small onion, diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups crushed tomatoes
- 1 cup sliced red bell pepper
- 1 tsp ground cumin and smoked paprika
- 1/2 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 6 large eggs
- 1/2 cup crumbled feta
- 2 tbsp chopped cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate the tomato base up to 4 days; add eggs only when reheating.
- Swap: Use goat cheese or omit cheese for dairy-free.
- Cook's tip: Simmer the sauce until thick before adding eggs so the whites set properly.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a wide skillet over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and lightly golden, 5 to 6 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, crushed tomatoes, and sliced red bell pepper. Cook until the vegetables are tender and excess moisture has evaporated.
3. Stir in the ground cumin and smoked paprika, salt, and pepper. Taste the base now because the eggs will mute the seasoning slightly.
4. Make six shallow wells in the mixture and crack an egg into each. Reduce the heat to medium-low and cover.
5. Cook until the whites are set but the yolks are still soft, 5 to 8 minutes. For firmer yolks, cook 2 to 3 minutes longer.
6. Scatter over the crumbled feta and chopped cilantro. Serve straight from the skillet with toast, flatbread, or roasted potatoes.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Spinach Mushroom Skillet Eggs

A savory skillet of eggs, mushrooms, spinach, Parmesan, and herbs.

**PREP**  
10 min

**COOK**  
25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 small onion, diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups sliced mushrooms
- 1 cup baby spinach
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1/2 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 6 large eggs
- 1/2 cup grated Parmesan
- 2 tbsp chopped chives

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate slices up to 4 days.
- Swap: Swap mushrooms for zucchini, asparagus, or roasted peppers.
- Cook's tip: Cook watery vegetables before adding eggs so the frittata stays firm.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a wide skillet over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and lightly golden, 5 to 6 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, sliced mushrooms, and baby spinach. Cook until the vegetables are tender and excess moisture has evaporated.
3. Stir in the dried thyme, salt, and pepper. Taste the base now because the eggs will mute the seasoning slightly.
4. Make six shallow wells in the mixture and crack an egg into each. Reduce the heat to medium-low and cover.
5. Cook until the whites are set but the yolks are still soft, 5 to 8 minutes. For firmer yolks, cook 2 to 3 minutes longer.
6. Scatter over the grated Parmesan and chopped chives. Serve straight from the skillet with toast, flatbread, or roasted potatoes.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Apple Cinnamon Oatmeal

*Creamy stovetop oats with tender apples, cinnamon, toasted pecans, and maple syrup.*

**PREP**  
10 min

**COOK**  
15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- 2 cups milk or unsweetened plant milk
- 1 cup water
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 1/2 cups diced apples
- 1/3 cup toasted pecans
- 2 tbsp maple syrup
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 tbsp butter or coconut oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days; reheat with extra milk.
- Swap: Use pears or berries and any toasted nut.
- Cook's tip: Add a small pinch of salt; it makes oatmeal taste sweeter without more sugar.

## METHOD

1. Combine the old-fashioned rolled oats, milk, water, salt, and ground cinnamon in a saucepan. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat.
2. Reduce the heat to low and cook, stirring often, until the grains are tender and the mixture is creamy. Add a splash of water if it becomes too thick before the grain softens.
3. Fold in half of the diced apples and cook for 1 to 2 minutes so it softens slightly without disappearing into the porridge.
4. Remove from the heat and stir in the vanilla, butter, and maple syrup. Taste and adjust the sweetness or salt.
5. Divide among bowls and top with the remaining diced apples and toasted pecans. Add extra milk around the edge for a looser texture.
6. For meal prep, cool completely before refrigerating and reheat with a splash of milk, stirring until creamy again.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Coconut Mango Quinoa Porridge

*A protein-rich breakfast bowl with coconut, mango, cardamom, and toasted coconut flakes.*

**PREP**  
10 min

**COOK**  
25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup rinsed quinoa
- 2 cups milk or unsweetened plant milk
- 1 cup water
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 1 tsp ground cardamom
- 1 1/2 cups diced ripe mango
- 1/3 cup toasted coconut flakes
- 2 tbsp honey or maple syrup
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 tbsp butter or coconut oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.
- Swap: Use pineapple, peaches, or berries instead of mango.
- Cook's tip: Rinse quinoa well to remove its naturally bitter coating.

## METHOD

1. Combine the rinsed quinoa, milk, water, salt, and ground cardamom in a saucepan. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat.
2. Reduce the heat to low and cook, stirring often, until the grains are tender and the mixture is creamy. Add a splash of water if it becomes too thick before the grain softens.
3. Fold in half of the diced ripe mango and cook for 1 to 2 minutes so it softens slightly without disappearing into the porridge.
4. Remove from the heat and stir in the vanilla, butter, and honey or maple syrup. Taste and adjust the sweetness or salt.
5. Divide among bowls and top with the remaining diced ripe mango and toasted coconut flakes. Add extra milk around the edge for a looser texture.
6. For meal prep, cool completely before refrigerating and reheat with a splash of milk, stirring until creamy again.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Savory Breakfast Burritos

*Hearty burritos filled with eggs, potatoes, black beans, cheddar, salsa, and avocado.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
20 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices large flour tortillas
- 2 cups soft scrambled eggs and roasted potatoes
- 1 1/2 cups black beans and sliced avocado
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 1/3 cup tomato salsa
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Wrap individually and refrigerate 3 days or freeze up to 1 month.
- Swap: Use tofu scramble or cooked sausage in place of eggs.
- Cook's tip: Cool the filling slightly before rolling to prevent soggy tortillas.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the large flour tortillas and spread the tomato salsa evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the soft scrambled eggs and roasted potatoes, black beans and sliced avocado, and shredded cheddar among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Wrap tightly and rest for 5 minutes before slicing. This brief rest helps the filling settle and keeps the sandwich neat.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Berry Cream Cheese Breakfast Sandwiches

*Brioche breakfast sandwiches layered with sweetened cream cheese, berries, and warm berry compote.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices thick brioche slices
- 2 cups sweetened cream cheese and mixed berries
- 1 1/2 cups thinly sliced strawberries
- 1 cup mascarpone or cream cheese
- 1/3 cup berry compote
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Best served fresh; refrigerate leftovers up to 2 days.
- Swap: Use sliced bananas, peaches, or jam for the berries.
- Cook's tip: Cook over medium-low heat so the center warms before the bread over-browns.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the thick brioche slices and spread the berry compote evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the sweetened cream cheese and mixed berries, thinly sliced strawberries, and mascarpone or cream cheese among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the thick brioche slices is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Scallion Ginger Savory Rice

*Savory ginger rice with mushrooms, chicken or egg, scallions, sesame, and crispy shallots.*

**PREP**  
10 min

**COOK**  
30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups jasmine rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups shredded cooked chicken or soft-boiled eggs
- 1 1/2 cups thinly sliced mushrooms
- 1 1/2 tsp grated ginger and white pepper
- 3 cups chicken or vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup scallions, sesame seeds, and crispy shallots

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked rice up to 4 days; reheat with a spoonful of stock.
- Swap: Use tofu, leftover roast pork, or roasted mushrooms as the topping.
- Cook's tip: Stir occasionally near the end to release starch and create a creamy texture.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the jasmine rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the shredded cooked chicken or soft-boiled eggs, thinly sliced mushrooms, and grated ginger and white pepper. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the jasmine rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the chicken or vegetable stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the scallions, sesame seeds, and crispy shallots. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Ham, Egg and Hollandaise Breakfast Melts

*Toasted English muffins layered with ham, eggs, spinach, and bright lemon hollandaise.*

**PREP**  
25 min

**COOK**  
20 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Advanced

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices split English muffins
- 2 cups sliced ham and chopped cooked eggs
- 1 1/2 cups baby spinach
- 1 cup shredded mild cheddar
- 1/3 cup lemon hollandaise
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Serve immediately; hollandaise does not hold well for long periods.
- Swap: Use smoked salmon, roasted tomato, or sauteed spinach instead of bacon.
- Cook's tip: Poach eggs in barely simmering water, not a rolling boil.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the split English muffins and spread the lemon hollandaise evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the sliced ham and chopped cooked eggs, baby spinach, and shredded mild cheddar among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the split English muffins is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Roasted Tomato Basil Soup

*Deep tomato flavor from roasting, balanced with basil and a small amount of cream.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
45 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups roasted tomatoes
- 2 cups red bell pepper
- 6 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp dried basil
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup heavy cream or unsweetened oat cream
- 2 tbsp fresh basil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Blend until completely smooth, then strain only if you want a restaurant-style texture.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and basil; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the roasted tomatoes and red bell pepper.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf. Stir in the cream and simmer gently for 2 minutes; do not boil hard after adding dairy. For a thicker texture, blend 2 cups of soup and stir it back into the pot.
6. Finish with the fresh basil. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Chicken Noodle Soup

*Comforting broth with tender chicken, vegetables, herbs, and egg noodles.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
35 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups shredded cooked chicken
- 2 cups egg noodles
- 6 cups chicken stock
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Add noodles near the end so they stay springy rather than bloated.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and thyme; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the shredded cooked chicken and egg noodles.
3. Pour in the chicken stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the fresh parsley. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Smoky Red Lentil Soup

*Fast-cooking lentils with carrots, tomato, cumin, and smoked paprika.*

**PREP**  
10 min

**COOK**  
30 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups red lentils
- 2 cups diced tomatoes
- 6 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp dried cumin
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp fresh cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Red lentils naturally break down; blend only part of the soup for a silky but textured result.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and cumin; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the red lentils and diced tomatoes.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the fresh cilantro. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Hearty Minestrone

*Italian vegetable soup with beans, pasta, tomatoes, and herbs.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
40 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cannellini beans
- 2 cups small pasta and zucchini
- 6 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley and Parmesan

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Keep cooked pasta separate if storing the soup for several days.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and oregano; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the cannellini beans and small pasta and zucchini.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the fresh parsley and Parmesan. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Potato Leek Soup

*Velvety potatoes and sweet leeks with thyme and a restrained cream finish.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
35 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups peeled diced potatoes
- 2 cups sliced leeks
- 6 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup heavy cream or unsweetened oat cream
- 2 tbsp chopped chives

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Rinse leeks between the layers; hidden grit can ruin an otherwise smooth soup.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and thyme; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the peeled diced potatoes and sliced leeks.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf. Stir in the cream and simmer gently for 2 minutes; do not boil hard after adding dairy. For a thicker texture, blend 2 cups of soup and stir it back into the pot.
6. Finish with the chopped chives. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Beef, Potato and Herb Soup

*A hearty broth-based soup with cooked beef, potatoes, carrots, red wine, and herbs.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
35 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked shredded beef
- 2 cups baby potatoes
- 6 cups beef stock with a splash of red wine
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Use fully cooked beef and add it near the end so it stays tender.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and thyme; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the cooked shredded beef and baby potatoes.
3. Pour in the beef stock with a splash of red wine, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the fresh parsley. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Thai Coconut Chicken Soup

*Aromatic coconut broth with chicken, mushrooms, lime, ginger, and chili.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups thinly sliced chicken thighs
- 2 cups mushrooms
- 6 cups coconut milk and chicken stock
- 1 tsp dried lemongrass and ginger
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp cilantro and lime

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Add lime juice after the soup stops boiling to keep its flavor fresh.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and lemongrass and ginger; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the thinly sliced chicken thighs and mushrooms.
3. Pour in the coconut milk and chicken stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the cilantro and lime. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Miso Udon Soup

*Light Japanese-inspired broth with udon, mushrooms, greens, tofu, and miso.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cubed firm tofu
- 2 cups udon noodles and mushrooms
- 6 cups dashi or vegetable stock
- 1 tsp dried ginger
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp scallions and sesame

### NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- Swap: Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- Cook's tip: Whisk miso with a ladle of warm broth and add it off the boil to preserve its aroma.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and ginger; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the cubed firm tofu and udon noodles and mushrooms.
3. Pour in the dashi or vegetable stock, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the scallions and sesame. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

### SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creole Chicken and Okra Soup

*A savory chicken soup with okra, peppers, tomato, and Creole seasoning.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
40 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked chicken
- 2 cups okra and bell peppers
- 6 cups chicken stock and crushed tomatoes
- 1 tsp dried Creole seasoning
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp scallions and parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- **Storage:** Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- **Swap:** Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- **Cook's tip:** Add okra after the broth simmers so it keeps some body and does not disappear into the soup.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and Creole seasoning; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the cooked chicken and okra and bell peppers.
3. Pour in the chicken stock and crushed tomatoes, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the scallions and parsley. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Moroccan Chickpea Stew

*Chickpeas, sweet potato, tomato, warming spices, and lemon in a satisfying one-pot meal.*

**PREP**  
15 min

**COOK**  
40 min

**SERVES**  
6

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked chickpeas
- 2 cups diced sweet potato
- 6 cups vegetable stock and crushed tomatoes
- 1 tsp dried cumin and cinnamon
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp fine salt, plus more to taste
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp cilantro and preserved lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- **Storage:** Refrigerate 4 days or freeze portions up to 2 months.
- **Swap:** Most soups tolerate seasonal vegetables well.
- **Cook's tip:** A spoonful of lemon juice at the end wakes up the warm spices.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery with a pinch of salt until softened, 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and cumin and cinnamon; cook for 30 seconds, just until fragrant. Stir in the cooked chickpeas and diced sweet potato.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock and crushed tomatoes, add the bay leaf, salt, and pepper, and bring to a boil. Reduce to a steady simmer.
4. Cook partially covered until the main ingredients are completely tender and the flavors have blended, 20 to 35 minutes depending on the recipe.
5. Remove the bay leaf and taste. Adjust salt, pepper, and acidity with a small squeeze of lemon if the soup tastes flat.
6. Finish with the cilantro and preserved lemon. Let the soup stand for 5 minutes before serving so the temperature and seasoning settle.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Caesar Salad

*Crisp romaine, Parmesan, croutons, and a creamy anchovy-garlic dressing.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups chopped romaine
- 2 cups garlic croutons
- 1/2 cup toasted breadcrumbs
- 1/2 cup shaved Parmesan
- 1/4 cup chopped parsley
- 1/3 cup Caesar dressing
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the chopped romaine thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the garlic croutons so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted breadcrumbs in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the Caesar dressing with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the chopped romaine with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the garlic croutons, toasted breadcrumbs, shaved Parmesan, and chopped parsley gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Greek Village Salad

Juicy tomatoes, cucumber, olives, red onion, and feta with oregano vinaigrette.

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups tomato wedges and cucumber
- 2 cups Kalamata olives and red onion
- 1/2 cup toasted pita chips
- 1/2 cup crumbled feta
- 1/4 cup fresh dill
- 1/3 cup oregano red-wine vinaigrette
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the tomato wedges and cucumber thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the Kalamata olives and red onion so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted pita chips in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the oregano red-wine vinaigrette with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the tomato wedges and cucumber with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the Kalamata olives and red onion, toasted pita chips, crumbled feta, and fresh dill gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Roasted Vegetable Quinoa Salad

*Nutty quinoa with roasted vegetables, feta, seeds, and lemon dressing.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups cooked quinoa
- 2 cups roasted zucchini, peppers, and onion
- 1/2 cup toasted pumpkin seeds
- 1/2 cup crumbled feta
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley
- 1/3 cup lemon tahini dressing
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the cooked quinoa thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the roasted zucchini, peppers, and onion so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted pumpkin seeds in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the lemon tahini dressing with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the cooked quinoa with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the roasted zucchini, peppers, and onion, toasted pumpkin seeds, crumbled feta, and fresh parsley gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Thai Green Mango Salad

*Sharp green mango, herbs, peanuts, vegetables, and a lime-chili dressing.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups shredded cabbage
- 2 cups julienned green mango and carrot
- 1/2 cup roasted peanuts
- 1/2 cup crumbled tofu or feta
- 1/4 cup mint and cilantro
- 1/3 cup lime chili dressing
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the shredded cabbage thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the julienned green mango and carrot so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the roasted peanuts in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the lime chili dressing with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the shredded cabbage with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the julienned green mango and carrot, roasted peanuts, crumbled tofu or feta, and mint and cilantro gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Caprese Panzanella

*Tomatoes, mozzarella, basil, and toasted bread tossed with balsamic vinaigrette.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups ripe tomatoes
- 2 cups toasted rustic bread cubes
- 1/2 cup toasted pine nuts
- 1/2 cup fresh mozzarella
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1/3 cup balsamic vinaigrette
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the ripe tomatoes thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the toasted rustic bread cubes so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted pine nuts in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the balsamic vinaigrette with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the ripe tomatoes with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the toasted rustic bread cubes, toasted pine nuts, fresh mozzarella, and fresh basil gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Nicoise-Style Tuna Salad

*Tuna, potatoes, green beans, olives, eggs, and greens with mustard vinaigrette.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups mixed greens
- 2 cups seared or canned tuna, potatoes, and green beans
- 1/2 cup Nicoise olives
- 1/2 cup quartered hard-boiled eggs
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley
- 1/3 cup Dijon vinaigrette
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the mixed greens thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the seared or canned tuna, potatoes, and green beans so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the Nicoise olives in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the Dijon vinaigrette with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the mixed greens with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the seared or canned tuna, potatoes, and green beans, Nicoise olives, quartered hard-boiled eggs, and fresh parsley gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Herbed Tabbouleh

*Parsley-forward bulgur salad with tomato, cucumber, mint, and lemon.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups finely chopped parsley
- 2 cups cooked fine bulgur, tomato, and cucumber
- 1/2 cup toasted sliced almonds
- 1/2 cup crumbled feta
- 1/4 cup fresh mint
- 1/3 cup lemon olive-oil dressing
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the finely chopped parsley thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the cooked fine bulgur, tomato, and cucumber so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted sliced almonds in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the lemon olive-oil dressing with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the finely chopped parsley with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the cooked fine bulgur, tomato, and cucumber, toasted sliced almonds, crumbled feta, and fresh mint gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Roasted Beet Goat Cheese Salad

*Sweet beets with arugula, goat cheese, walnuts, and orange vinaigrette.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups baby arugula
- 2 cups roasted beet wedges and orange segments
- 1/2 cup toasted walnuts
- 1/2 cup crumbled goat cheese
- 1/4 cup fresh chives
- 1/3 cup orange balsamic vinaigrette
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the baby arugula thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the roasted beet wedges and orange segments so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted walnuts in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the orange balsamic vinaigrette with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the baby arugula with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the roasted beet wedges and orange segments, toasted walnuts, crumbled goat cheese, and fresh chives gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Sesame Soba Noodle Salad

*Chilled buckwheat noodles with crunchy vegetables and sesame-soy dressing.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups cooked chilled soba noodles
- 2 cups shredded carrot, cucumber, and edamame
- 1/2 cup toasted sesame seeds
- 1/2 cup crumbled tofu
- 1/4 cup scallions and cilantro
- 1/3 cup sesame soy dressing
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the cooked chilled soba noodles thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the shredded carrot, cucumber, and edamame so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the toasted sesame seeds in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the sesame soy dressing with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the cooked chilled soba noodles with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the shredded carrot, cucumber, and edamame, toasted sesame seeds, crumbled tofu, and scallions and cilantro gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Southwest Black Bean Salad

*Black beans, corn, peppers, avocado, tortilla crunch, and cumin-lime dressing.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
0-25 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 6 cups chopped romaine
- 2 cups black beans, corn, tomato, and avocado
- 1/2 cup crushed tortilla chips
- 1/2 cup crumbled cotija or cheddar
- 1/4 cup fresh cilantro
- 1/3 cup cumin lime dressing
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Keep dressed salad no more than 1 day; store components separately for 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use the same dressing formula with seasonal produce.
- Cook's tip: Season the main components individually before tossing so the salad tastes balanced throughout.

## METHOD

1. Wash and dry the chopped romaine thoroughly. Excess water dilutes dressing and prevents it from clinging to the leaves.
2. Prepare the black beans, corn, tomato, and avocado so all pieces are bite-size and evenly seasoned. If it is cooked, cool it until just warm before assembling.
3. Toast the crushed tortilla chips in a dry skillet for 2 to 4 minutes if appropriate; this deepens flavor and keeps the texture crisp.
4. Whisk the cumin lime dressing with the lemon juice or vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until emulsified. Taste before using.
5. Toss the chopped romaine with about two-thirds of the dressing. Fold in the black beans, corn, tomato, and avocado, crushed tortilla chips, crumbled cotija or cheddar, and fresh cilantro gently so delicate ingredients stay intact.
6. Add more dressing only as needed and serve immediately. For packed lunches, keep the dressing and crunchy ingredients separate until eating.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Crispy Three-Cheese Grilled Cheese

*A deeply golden sandwich with cheddar, mozzarella, Parmesan, and a tangy mustard layer.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices sourdough bread
- 2 cups caramelized onions
- 1 1/2 cups thin tomato slices
- 1 cup cheddar, mozzarella, and Parmesan
- 1/3 cup Dijon mustard
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the sourdough bread and spread the Dijon mustard evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the caramelized onions, thin tomato slices, and cheddar, mozzarella, and Parmesan among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the sourdough bread is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Vietnamese-Inspired Chicken Banh Mi

*Savory chicken, quick-pickled vegetables, cucumber, herbs, and chili mayo in a crisp baguette.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices small baguettes
- 2 cups lemongrass chicken
- 1 1/2 cups quick-pickled carrot, daikon, and cucumber
- 1 cup thin sliced cucumber
- 1/3 cup chili mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the small baguettes and spread the chili mayonnaise evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the lemongrass chicken, quick-pickled carrot, daikon, and cucumber, and thin sliced cucumber among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Wrap tightly and rest for 5 minutes before slicing. This brief rest helps the filling settle and keeps the sandwich neat.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Falafel Tahini Wraps

*Herby falafel, lettuce, tomato, pickles, and tahini wrapped in warm flatbread.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices large pita or flatbread
- 2 cups warm falafel
- 1 1/2 cups shredded lettuce, tomato, and pickles
- 1 cup crumbled feta
- 1/3 cup lemon tahini sauce
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the large pita or flatbread and spread the lemon tahini sauce evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the warm falafel, shredded lettuce, tomato, and pickles, and crumbled feta among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Wrap tightly and rest for 5 minutes before slicing. This brief rest helps the filling settle and keeps the sandwich neat.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Turkey Avocado Club

*Roasted turkey, bacon, avocado, tomato, lettuce, and mayo stacked on toast.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

0-15 min

**SERVES**

4

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices toasted sandwich bread
- 2 cups sliced roast turkey and crisp bacon
- 1 1/2 cups tomato, lettuce, and avocado
- 1 cup sliced cheddar
- 1/3 cup herbed mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the toasted sandwich bread and spread the herbed mayonnaise evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the sliced roast turkey and crisp bacon, tomato, lettuce, and avocado, and sliced cheddar among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Wrap tightly and rest for 5 minutes before slicing. This brief rest helps the filling settle and keeps the sandwich neat.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cuban-Style Pressed Sandwich

*Roast pork, ham, Swiss, pickles, and mustard pressed until crisp and molten.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices Cuban bread or soft baguette
- 2 cups roast pork and sliced ham
- 1 1/2 cups dill pickle slices
- 1 cup Swiss cheese
- 1/3 cup yellow mustard
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the Cuban bread or soft baguette and spread the yellow mustard evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the roast pork and sliced ham, dill pickle slices, and Swiss cheese among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the Cuban bread or soft baguette is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chicken Shawarma Pitas

*Spiced chicken, chopped salad, pickles, and garlic sauce tucked into warm pita.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices pita breads
- 2 cups shawarma-spiced chicken
- 1 1/2 cups tomato, cucumber, and pickled turnip
- 1 cup crumbled feta
- 1/3 cup garlic yogurt sauce
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the pita breads and spread the garlic yogurt sauce evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the shawarma-spiced chicken, tomato, cucumber, and pickled turnip, and crumbled feta among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Wrap tightly and rest for 5 minutes before slicing. This brief rest helps the filling settle and keeps the sandwich neat.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Tuna Melt with Pickles

*Creamy tuna salad, sharp cheddar, tomato, and pickles on griddled rye.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices rye bread
- 2 cups lemon-dill tuna salad
- 1 1/2 cups sliced tomato and pickles
- 1 cup sharp cheddar
- 1/3 cup Dijon mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the rye bread and spread the Dijon mayonnaise evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the lemon-dill tuna salad, sliced tomato and pickles, and sharp cheddar among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the rye bread is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Roasted Vegetable Pesto Panini

*Roasted zucchini, peppers, mushrooms, pesto, and provolone on focaccia.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices focaccia slices
- 2 cups roasted mixed vegetables
- 1 1/2 cups baby spinach
- 1 cup provolone
- 1/3 cup basil pesto
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the focaccia slices and spread the basil pesto evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the roasted mixed vegetables, baby spinach, and provolone among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the focaccia slices is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# BBQ Pulled Jackfruit Sandwich

*Smoky jackfruit with crunchy slaw and pickles on a toasted bun.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
0-15 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices brioche or potato buns
- 2 cups BBQ pulled jackfruit
- 1 1/2 cups vinegar slaw and pickles
- 1 cup sliced smoked gouda
- 1/3 cup barbecue sauce
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the brioche or potato buns and spread the barbecue sauce evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the BBQ pulled jackfruit, vinegar slaw and pickles, and sliced smoked gouda among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Wrap tightly and rest for 5 minutes before slicing. This brief rest helps the filling settle and keeps the sandwich neat.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# New England-Style Lobster Rolls

*Tender lobster lightly dressed with lemon mayo, celery, and chives in toasted split-top buns.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

0-15 min

**SERVES**

4

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 8 pieces or slices split-top hot dog buns
- 2 cups cooked lobster meat
- 1 1/2 cups finely diced celery and lettuce
- 1 cup extra lobster meat and chives
- 1/3 cup lemon chive mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp softened butter or olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs or pickles

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most assembled sandwiches are best the same day; refrigerate fillings separately up to 3 days.
- Swap: Swap breads and vegetables freely while keeping moisture under control.
- Cook's tip: Spread condiments edge to edge for even seasoning and a moisture barrier.

## METHOD

1. Lay out the split-top hot dog buns and spread the lemon chive mayonnaise evenly to the edges so every bite is seasoned.
2. Divide the cooked lobster meat, finely diced celery and lettuce, and extra lobster meat and chives among four servings. Season lightly with salt and pepper, keeping wetter ingredients away from the bread when possible.
3. Close, fold, or roll each handheld as appropriate and press gently. Brush the outside with butter or olive oil if serving it hot.
4. Cook in a skillet or sandwich press over medium heat until the split-top hot dog buns is deeply golden and the filling is hot, 3 to 5 minutes per side. Lower the heat if the bread browns before the center warms.
5. Open one corner and add the fresh herbs or pickles if you want extra brightness and crunch.
6. Slice with a serrated knife and serve immediately, or wrap tightly for travel.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Black Pepper Pancetta Spaghetti

*Silky spaghetti with pancetta, Pecorino, black pepper, and a light cream sauce.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
20-90 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz spaghetti
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp freshly ground black pepper
- 2 cups egg and Pecorino mixture
- 1 1/2 cups crisp pancetta or guanciale
- 3/4 cup Pecorino Romano
- 1/4 cup chopped parsley
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the spaghetti until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the freshly ground black pepper until fragrant, then add the crisp pancetta or guanciale and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the egg and Pecorino mixture and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained spaghetti and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the Pecorino Romano and chopped parsley. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Slow Bolognese Tagliatelle

*Rich meat and tomato ragù tossed with broad noodles and Parmesan.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

20-90 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz tagliatelle
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic
- 2 cups slow-cooked tomato meat ragù
- 1 1/2 cups finely diced carrot and celery
- 3/4 cup grated Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

### NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the tagliatelle until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic until fragrant, then add the finely diced carrot and celery and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the slow-cooked tomato meat ragù and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained tagliatelle and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the grated Parmesan and fresh basil. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

### SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Basil Pesto Linguine

*Bright pesto, cherry tomatoes, Parmesan, and toasted pine nuts with linguine.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
20-90 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz linguine
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic
- 2 cups basil pesto
- 1 1/2 cups halved cherry tomatoes
- 3/4 cup grated Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the linguine until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic until fragrant, then add the halved cherry tomatoes and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the basil pesto and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained linguine and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the grated Parmesan and fresh basil. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creamy Baked Mac and Cheese

*Sharp cheddar sauce, macaroni, mustard, and a crisp breadcrumb topping.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
20-90 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz elbow macaroni
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 2 cups cheddar bechamel sauce
- 1 1/2 cups toasted breadcrumbs
- 3/4 cup sharp cheddar
- 1/4 cup chopped chives
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the elbow macaroni until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the Dijon mustard until fragrant, then add the toasted breadcrumbs and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the cheddar bechamel sauce and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained elbow macaroni and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the sharp cheddar and chopped chives. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Transfer to a lightly greased baking dish, top with the remaining cheese, and bake at 400 F for 15 to 20 minutes until bubbling and browned at the edges. Rest 10 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Baked Beef and Ricotta Rigatoni

*Rigatoni baked with beef ragù, ricotta, mozzarella, Parmesan, and basil.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
20-90 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz rigatoni
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic
- 2 cups beef tomato ragù
- 1 1/2 cups ricotta mixture
- 3/4 cup mozzarella and Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the rigatoni until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic until fragrant, then add the ricotta mixture and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the beef tomato ragù and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained rigatoni and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the mozzarella and Parmesan and fresh basil. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Transfer to a lightly greased baking dish, top with the remaining cheese, and bake at 400 F for 15 to 20 minutes until bubbling and browned at the edges. Rest 10 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Pecorino Black Pepper Spaghetti

*A simple pasta of Pecorino, black pepper, butter, and starchy pasta water.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

20-90 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz tonnamelli or spaghetti
- 1 tbs fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbs olive oil or butter
- 2 tbs toasted black pepper
- 2 cups Pecorino and pasta-water emulsion
- 1 1/2 cups extra Pecorino
- 3/4 cup Pecorino Romano
- 1/4 cup flat-leaf parsley
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the tonnamelli or spaghetti until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the toasted black pepper until fragrant, then add the extra Pecorino and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the Pecorino and pasta-water emulsion and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained tonnamelli or spaghetti and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the Pecorino Romano and flat-leaf parsley. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lemon Ricotta Fusilli

*Twisty pasta with lemon ricotta sauce, peas, spinach, Parmesan, and herbs.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

20-90 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz fusilli
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic and lemon zest
- 2 cups lemon ricotta sauce
- 1 1/2 cups peas and baby spinach
- 3/4 cup grated Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the fusilli until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic and lemon zest until fragrant, then add the peas and baby spinach and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the lemon ricotta sauce and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained fusilli and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the grated Parmesan and fresh basil. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Roasted Red Pepper Penne

*Penne in a silky roasted pepper sauce with spinach, Parmesan, and basil.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
20-90 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz penne
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic
- 2 cups roasted red pepper tomato sauce
- 1 1/2 cups baby spinach
- 3/4 cup grated Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the penne until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic until fragrant, then add the baby spinach and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the roasted red pepper tomato sauce and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained penne and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the grated Parmesan and fresh basil. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creamy Mushroom Farfalle

*Bow-tie pasta with browned mushrooms, a light cream sauce, Parmesan, and thyme.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
20-90 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz farfalle
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic and shallot
- 2 cups light mushroom cream sauce
- 1 1/2 cups browned mushrooms
- 3/4 cup grated Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh thyme
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the farfalle until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic and shallot until fragrant, then add the browned mushrooms and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the light mushroom cream sauce and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained farfalle and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the grated Parmesan and fresh thyme. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Broccoli Garlic Orecchiette

*Orecchiette with broccoli, garlic, chili, lemon, Parmesan, and parsley.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

20-90 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz orecchiette
- 1 tbsp fine salt for the pasta water
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 tbsp minced garlic and chili flakes
- 2 cups garlic lemon olive-oil sauce
- 1 1/2 cups small broccoli florets
- 3/4 cup grated Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup reserved pasta water

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most pasta 3 to 4 days; sauce and pasta keep best separately.
- Swap: Use a shape with similar thickness when swapping pasta.
- Cook's tip: Reserved pasta water is an ingredient: its starch helps sauces emulsify and cling.

## METHOD

1. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, salt it well, and cook the orecchiette until just shy of al dente. Reserve at least 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.
2. Heat the olive oil or butter in a wide pan. Cook the minced garlic and chili flakes until fragrant, then add the small broccoli florets and cook until properly browned or tender.
3. Add the garlic lemon olive-oil sauce and simmer until it coats the back of a spoon. Season with black pepper and taste before adding extra salt.
4. Add the drained orecchiette and 1/4 cup pasta water. Toss over medium heat until the sauce clings to every piece, adding more water a spoonful at a time if needed.
5. Remove from the heat and fold in most of the grated Parmesan and fresh parsley. The residual heat should melt the cheese without making the sauce greasy.
6. Serve immediately in warm bowls, finishing with the remaining cheese and herbs.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Mushroom Parmesan Rice Pilaf

*Fluffy rice pilaf with browned mushrooms, Parmesan, peas, and herbs.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups long-grain rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups sliced mushrooms
- 1 1/2 cups peas
- 1 1/2 tsp thyme
- 3 cups warm vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup Parmesan and parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the long-grain rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the sliced mushrooms, peas, and thyme. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the long-grain rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the warm vegetable stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the Parmesan and parsley. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Spanish-Style Saffron Vegetable Rice

*Saffron rice with peppers, peas, artichokes, tomato, and smoky paprika.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups short-grain rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups chickpeas and artichoke hearts
- 1 1/2 cups red pepper and peas
- 1 1/2 tsp saffron and smoked paprika
- 3 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the short-grain rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the chickpeas and artichoke hearts, red pepper and peas, and saffron and smoked paprika. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the short-grain rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the vegetable stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the parsley and lemon. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chicken Biryani

*Fragrant basmati rice layered with spiced chicken, caramelized onions, herbs, and yogurt.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups basmati rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups yogurt-marinated chicken
- 1 1/2 cups caramelized onions and peas
- 1 1/2 tsp garam masala and saffron
- 3 cups chicken stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup mint, cilantro, and fried onions

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the basmati rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the yogurt-marinated chicken, caramelized onions and peas, and garam masala and saffron. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the basmati rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the chicken stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the mint, cilantro, and fried onions. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Kimchi Fried Rice

*Spicy-savory fried rice with kimchi, egg, scallions, sesame, and optional pork or tofu.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups cold cooked short-grain rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups chopped kimchi and diced tofu or pork
- 1 1/2 cups peas and carrots
- 1 1/2 tsp gochujang and sesame oil
- 3 cups kimchi juice
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup scallions, sesame, and fried egg

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Cook the cold cooked short-grain rice ahead of time and chill it completely; cold, dry grains fry instead of steaming.
2. Heat half the oil in a wok or large skillet over high heat. Cook the chopped kimchi and diced tofu or pork until browned and nearly done, then transfer to a plate.
3. Add the remaining oil, onion, garlic, and peas and carrots. Stir-fry until crisp-tender, keeping the pan hot.
4. Add the cold cold cooked short-grain rice and gochujang and sesame oil. Toss and press the grains against the hot pan for 2 to 3 minutes so some edges become toasted.
5. Return the chopped kimchi and diced tofu or pork, season with salt and pepper, and toss until piping hot. Add a splash of the kimchi juice only if the mixture seems dry.
6. Fold in the scallions, sesame, and fried egg just before serving so it stays fresh and bright.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creole Jambalaya

*One-pot rice with chicken, sausage, peppers, tomato, and Creole spices.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups long-grain rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups chicken and smoked sausage
- 1 1/2 cups bell pepper and celery
- 1 1/2 tsp Creole seasoning
- 3 cups chicken stock and crushed tomatoes
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup scallions and parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the long-grain rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the chicken and smoked sausage, bell pepper and celery, and Creole seasoning. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the long-grain rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the chicken stock and crushed tomatoes, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the scallions and parsley. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lemon Herb Rice Pilaf

*Fluffy rice toasted with onion, lemon, herbs, and sliced almonds.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups basmati rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups sliced almonds
- 1 1/2 cups peas
- 1 1/2 tsp dried oregano and lemon zest
- 3 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup fresh parsley and dill

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the basmati rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the sliced almonds, peas, and dried oregano and lemon zest. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the basmati rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the vegetable stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the fresh parsley and dill. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Coconut Ginger Rice Bowls

*Fragrant coconut rice with edamame, carrots, cucumber, sesame, and scallions.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups jasmine rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups shelled edamame
- 1 1/2 cups carrot and cucumber
- 1 1/2 tsp ginger and sesame
- 3 cups light coconut milk and water
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup scallions and sesame seeds

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the jasmine rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the shelled edamame, carrot and cucumber, and ginger and sesame. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the jasmine rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the light coconut milk and water, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the scallions and sesame seeds. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Gochujang Mushroom Rice

*Savory rice with mushrooms, spinach, carrots, gochujang, sesame, and scallions.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups short-grain rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups sliced mushrooms
- 1 1/2 cups spinach and carrots
- 1 1/2 tsp gochujang and sesame
- 3 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup scallions and sesame seeds

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the short-grain rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the sliced mushrooms, spinach and carrots, and gochujang and sesame. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the short-grain rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the vegetable stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the scallions and sesame seeds. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Moroccan Couscous with Vegetables

*Fluffy couscous with roasted vegetables, chickpeas, raisins, and warm spices.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups couscous
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups cooked chickpeas
- 1 1/2 cups roasted zucchini and carrots
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin and cinnamon
- 3 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup parsley, mint, and toasted almonds

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the couscous under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the cooked chickpeas, roasted zucchini and carrots, and cumin and cinnamon. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the couscous until every grain is coated. Pour in the vegetable stock, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the parsley, mint, and toasted almonds. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chipotle Black Bean Rice

*Cilantro-lime rice with black beans, corn, peppers, tomato, cumin, and chipotle.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups long-grain rice
- 2 tbsp oil or butter
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 cups black beans
- 1 1/2 cups corn and bell pepper
- 1 1/2 tsp ground cumin and chipotle
- 3 cups vegetable stock and tomato
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup cilantro and lime

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked grains up to 4 days and cool promptly before storing.
- Swap: Swap grains with similar cooking times or cook them separately before combining.
- Cook's tip: Rest covered grains off the heat before fluffing so moisture redistributes evenly.

## METHOD

1. Rinse the long-grain rice under cool water until the water runs mostly clear, unless using a grain such as risotto rice that should retain surface starch.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a heavy pot. Cook the onion until soft, then add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
3. Add the black beans, corn and bell pepper, and ground cumin and chipotle. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes to toast the spices and lightly brown the main ingredient.
4. Stir in the long-grain rice until every grain is coated. Pour in the vegetable stock and tomato, add salt and pepper, and bring to a boil.
5. Cover, reduce to low, and cook until the liquid is absorbed and the grain is tender. Turn off the heat and rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. Fluff gently with a fork and fold in the cilantro and lime. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Eggplant Tomato Mozzarella Skillet

*Tender eggplant and spinach simmered in tomato-basil sauce with mozzarella and Parmesan.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups diced eggplant
- 2 cups sauteed spinach
- 2 cups tomato basil sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp Italian seasoning
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup mozzarella and Parmesan
- spaghetti or crusty bread, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and Italian seasoning; stir for 30 seconds. Add the diced eggplant and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the sauteed spinach and tomato basil sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the mozzarella and Parmesan, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over spaghetti or crusty bread and scatter with the remaining mozzarella and Parmesan. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Creamy Chickpea Curry

*Chickpeas simmered with tomato, coconut milk, spinach, and warm spices.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked chickpeas
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 2 cups tomato coconut sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp garam masala
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup cilantro and yogurt
- basmati rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and garam masala; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cooked chickpeas and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the baby spinach and tomato coconut sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the cilantro and yogurt, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over basmati rice and scatter with the remaining cilantro and yogurt. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lentil Mushroom Gravy Bowls

*Savory lentils, mushrooms, peas, and carrots in herb gravy, served over mashed potatoes.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked brown lentils
- 2 cups peas, carrots, and mushrooms
- 2 cups mushroom gravy
- 1 1/2 tsp thyme and rosemary
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup chopped parsley
- mashed potatoes, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and thyme and rosemary; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cooked brown lentils and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the peas, carrots, and mushrooms and mushroom gravy. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the chopped parsley, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over mashed potatoes and scatter with the remaining chopped parsley. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Mushroom Stroganoff

*Browned mushrooms in a tangy paprika cream sauce with egg noodles.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups mixed mushrooms
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 2 cups sour cream mushroom sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup parsley and Parmesan
- buttered egg noodles, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and smoked paprika; stir for 30 seconds. Add the mixed mushrooms and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the baby spinach and sour cream mushroom sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the parsley and Parmesan, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over buttered egg noodles and scatter with the remaining parsley and Parmesan. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Mediterranean Pepper and Chickpea Skillet

*Bell peppers, chickpeas, tomato, herbs, feta, and olives in a bright skillet meal.*

**PREP**

20-35 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups sliced bell peppers
- 2 cups cooked chickpeas
- 2 cups tomato herb sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp oregano and cumin
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup feta and olives
- couscous, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and oregano and cumin; stir for 30 seconds. Add the sliced bell peppers and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the cooked chickpeas and tomato herb sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the feta and olives, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over couscous and scatter with the remaining feta and olives. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Harissa Cauliflower Chickpea Skillet

*Cauliflower and chickpeas in a warm harissa sauce with yogurt, herbs, and toasted almonds.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cauliflower florets
- 2 cups cooked chickpeas
- 2 cups harissa yogurt sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin and coriander
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup toasted almonds and parsley
- couscous, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and cumin and coriander; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cauliflower florets and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the cooked chickpeas and harissa yogurt sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the toasted almonds and parsley, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over couscous and scatter with the remaining toasted almonds and parsley. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Black Bean Enchilada Skillet

*Black beans, corn, peppers, onions, red enchilada sauce, cheese, and cilantro in one pan.*

**PREP**

20-35 min

**COOK**

25-60 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups black beans and corn
- 2 cups sauteed peppers and onions
- 2 cups red enchilada sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin and chili powder
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup Monterey Jack and cilantro
- Mexican rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and cumin and chili powder; stir for 30 seconds. Add the black beans and corn and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the sauteed peppers and onions and red enchilada sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the Monterey Jack and cilantro, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over Mexican rice and scatter with the remaining Monterey Jack and cilantro. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Crispy Tofu Coconut Curry

*Golden tofu with vegetables in a coconut-lime curry sauce.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups pressed cubed tofu
- 2 cups broccoli and red pepper
- 2 cups coconut curry sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp Thai curry powder or paste
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup cilantro and lime
- jasmine rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and Thai curry powder or paste; stir for 30 seconds. Add the pressed cubed tofu and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the broccoli and red pepper and coconut curry sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the cilantro and lime, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over jasmine rice and scatter with the remaining cilantro and lime. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creamy Vegetable Herb Skillet

*Carrots, peas, mushrooms, potatoes, and green beans in a creamy thyme sauce.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups mixed carrots, peas, mushrooms, and potatoes
- 2 cups green beans
- 2 cups creamy herb sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp thyme
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup Parmesan and parsley
- crusty bread, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and thyme; stir for 30 seconds. Add the mixed carrots, peas, mushrooms, and potatoes and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the green beans and creamy herb sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the Parmesan and parsley, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over crusty bread and scatter with the remaining Parmesan and parsley. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Zucchini Feta Corn Skillet

*Zucchini, corn, scallions, feta, dill, and lemon yogurt in a quick vegetable skillet.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups diced zucchini
- 2 cups corn and scallions
- 2 cups lemon yogurt sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp dill and black pepper
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup crumbled feta and herbs
- warm pita, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate most dishes 3 to 4 days.
- Swap: Use plant-based cheese or cream where appropriate for dairy-free versions.
- Cook's tip: Brown vegetables in batches; crowding traps steam and weakens flavor.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and dill and black pepper; stir for 30 seconds. Add the diced zucchini and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the corn and scallions and lemon yogurt sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the crumbled feta and herbs, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over warm pita and scatter with the remaining crumbled feta and herbs. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Three-Bean Vegan Chili

*A hearty tomato chili with three beans, corn, peppers, cocoa, and smoky spices.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups kidney, black, and pinto beans
- 2 cups corn and bell pepper
- 2 cups fire-roasted tomato sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp chili powder and smoked paprika
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup avocado and cilantro
- brown rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and chili powder and smoked paprika; stir for 30 seconds. Add the kidney, black, and pinto beans and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the corn and bell pepper and fire-roasted tomato sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the avocado and cilantro, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over brown rice and scatter with the remaining avocado and cilantro. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Turmeric Tofu Spinach Skillet

*Tofu, spinach, peppers, turmeric, cashew cream, avocado, and scallions.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cubed firm tofu
- 2 cups spinach and bell pepper
- 2 cups light cashew cream
- 1 1/2 tsp turmeric and black pepper
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup avocado and scallions
- whole-grain toast, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and turmeric and black pepper; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cubed firm tofu and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the spinach and bell pepper and light cashew cream. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the avocado and scallions, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over whole-grain toast and scatter with the remaining avocado and scallions. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Smoky BBQ Jackfruit Skillet

*Pulled jackfruit with cabbage, barbecue sauce, smoked paprika, avocado, and cilantro.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups shredded young jackfruit
- 2 cups cabbage and red onion
- 2 cups barbecue sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp smoked paprika and cumin
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup avocado and cilantro
- warm corn tortillas, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and smoked paprika and cumin; stir for 30 seconds. Add the shredded young jackfruit and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the cabbage and red onion and barbecue sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the avocado and cilantro, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over warm corn tortillas and scatter with the remaining avocado and cilantro. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Coconut Red Lentil Dal

*Creamy red lentils with coconut milk, tomato, ginger, and toasted spices.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups red lentils
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 2 cups coconut tomato sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin, turmeric, and coriander
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup cilantro and lime
- basmati rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and cumin, turmeric, and coriander; stir for 30 seconds. Add the red lentils and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the baby spinach and coconut tomato sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the cilantro and lime, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over basmati rice and scatter with the remaining cilantro and lime. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Sesame Tempeh Broccoli Skillet

*Glazed tempeh with broccoli, carrots, sesame-soy sauce, ginger, and scallions.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cubed tempeh
- 2 cups broccoli and carrots
- 2 cups sesame soy sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp ginger and five-spice
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup sesame seeds and scallions
- brown rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and ginger and five-spice; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cubed tempeh and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the broccoli and carrots and sesame soy sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the sesame seeds and scallions, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over brown rice and scatter with the remaining sesame seeds and scallions. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Miso Tofu Mushroom Skillet

*Tofu, bok choy, mushrooms, corn, and miso-sesame sauce with ginger and chili.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups seared tofu
- 2 cups bok choy and mushrooms
- 2 cups miso sesame sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp ginger and chili
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup scallions and nori
- steamed rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and ginger and chili; stir for 30 seconds. Add the seared tofu and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the bok choy and mushrooms and miso sesame sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the scallions and nori, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over steamed rice and scatter with the remaining scallions and nori. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Walnut Lentil Taco Skillet

*Savory lentils and walnuts with corn, onion, tomato, cumin, chili, lime, and avocado.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked brown lentils and chopped walnuts
- 2 cups corn and onion
- 2 cups tomato salsa sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin and chili powder
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup cilantro and avocado
- corn tortillas, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and cumin and chili powder; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cooked brown lentils and chopped walnuts and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the corn and onion and tomato salsa sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the cilantro and avocado, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over corn tortillas and scatter with the remaining cilantro and avocado. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Mushroom Lentil Mustard Skillet

*Herby mushrooms and lentils with spinach, mustard sauce, thyme, and parsley.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked lentils and mushrooms
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 2 cups mustard herb sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp thyme and black pepper
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup toasted seeds and parsley
- roasted potatoes, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and thyme and black pepper; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cooked lentils and mushrooms and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the baby spinach and mustard herb sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the toasted seeds and parsley, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over roasted potatoes and scatter with the remaining toasted seeds and parsley. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Sweet Potato Peanut Curry

*Sweet potatoes and chickpeas in a creamy peanut-tomato sauce with greens.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups diced sweet potato and chickpeas
- 2 cups kale
- 2 cups tomato peanut sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp curry powder and ginger
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup peanuts and cilantro
- jasmine rice, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and curry powder and ginger; stir for 30 seconds. Add the diced sweet potato and chickpeas and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the kale and tomato peanut sauce. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the peanuts and cilantro, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over jasmine rice and scatter with the remaining peanuts and cilantro. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Vegan Lentil Gravy Bowls

*Lentils, mushrooms, carrots, and peas in savory herb gravy over olive-oil mashed potatoes.*

**PREP**  
20-35 min

**COOK**  
25-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 cups cooked lentils and mushrooms
- 2 cups peas and carrots
- 2 cups savory vegetable gravy
- 1 1/2 tsp rosemary and thyme
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 cup chopped parsley
- olive-oil mashed potatoes, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many stews freeze well for 2 months.
- Swap: Use seasonal vegetables while keeping the sauce and spice profile the same.
- Cook's tip: Add acid at the end of plant-based dishes to make flavors taste brighter and more complete.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook the onion until soft and beginning to color.
2. Add the garlic and rosemary and thyme; stir for 30 seconds. Add the cooked lentils and mushrooms and cook until browned in spots, working in batches if the pan is crowded.
3. Add the peas and carrots and savory vegetable gravy. Scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan and bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Cook until the vegetables are completely tender but still hold their shape and the sauce has reduced enough to cling to them.
5. Season with salt and pepper. Fold in half of the chopped parsley, reserving the rest for the finish.
6. Serve over olive-oil mashed potatoes and scatter with the remaining chopped parsley. Add lemon or vinegar at the table if you want more brightness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lemon Herb Roast Chicken

*Juicy chicken with lemon, garlic, rosemary, thyme, and pan juices.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb bone-in skin-on chicken pieces
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups baby potatoes and carrots
- 1 1/2 cups lemon garlic pan sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp rosemary and thyme
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon zest

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the bone-in skin-on chicken pieces dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and baby potatoes and carrots until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the rosemary and thyme, then add the lemon garlic pan sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the parsley and lemon zest. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Butter Chicken

*Tender chicken in a velvety tomato, butter, cream, and garam masala sauce.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-75 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb boneless chicken thighs
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups onion and bell pepper
- 1 1/2 cups tomato butter cream sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp garam masala and fenugreek
- 1/4 cup cilantro and yogurt

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the boneless chicken thighs dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and onion and bell pepper until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the garam masala and fenugreek, then add the tomato butter cream sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the cilantro and yogurt. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chicken Piccata

*Pan-seared chicken cutlets in a bright lemon, caper, butter, and parsley sauce.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb thin chicken cutlets
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups green beans
- 1 1/2 cups lemon caper butter sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp garlic and black pepper
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the thin chicken cutlets dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and green beans until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the garlic and black pepper, then add the lemon caper butter sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the parsley and lemon. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Teriyaki Chicken

*Glossy soy-ginger chicken with broccoli, sesame, and scallions.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-75 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb boneless chicken thighs
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 1 1/2 cups teriyaki sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp ginger and garlic
- 1/4 cup sesame seeds and scallions

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the boneless chicken thighs dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and broccoli florets until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the ginger and garlic, then add the teriyaki sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the sesame seeds and scallions. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Filipino-Style Chicken Adobo

*Chicken braised in soy, vinegar, garlic, bay leaf, and black pepper.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

25-75 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb bone-in chicken thighs
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups sliced onion
- 1 1/2 cups soy vinegar adobo sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp bay leaf and black pepper
- 1/4 cup scallions

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the bone-in chicken thighs dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and sliced onion until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the bay leaf and black pepper, then add the soy vinegar adobo sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the scallions. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Jerk Chicken

*Spicy aromatic chicken with allspice, thyme, scallion, chili, and lime.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb chicken thighs or drumsticks
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups bell peppers and onion
- 1 1/2 cups jerk marinade and pan juices
- 1 1/2 tsp allspice and thyme
- 1/4 cup scallions and lime

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the chicken thighs or drumsticks dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and bell peppers and onion until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the allspice and thyme, then add the jerk marinade and pan juices. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the scallions and lime. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Paprika Lemon Chicken Cutlets

*Thin chicken cutlets seared with paprika and garlic, finished in lemon butter with herbs.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb thin chicken cutlets
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups arugula and tomato
- 1 1/2 cups lemon butter pan sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp paprika and garlic
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon wedges

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the thin chicken cutlets dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and arugula and tomato until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the paprika and garlic, then add the lemon butter pan sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the parsley and lemon wedges. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Turkey Meatballs in Tomato Sauce

*Tender turkey meatballs simmered in garlicky tomato sauce with basil and Parmesan.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb ground turkey meatballs
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups sauteed zucchini
- 1 1/2 cups tomato basil sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp Italian seasoning
- 1/4 cup Parmesan and basil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the ground turkey meatballs dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and sauteed zucchini until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the Italian seasoning, then add the tomato basil sauce. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the Parmesan and basil. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creamy Chicken Vegetable Skillet

*Chicken, peas, carrots, celery, thyme, and sage in a creamy skillet gravy.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb cooked chicken
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups peas, carrots, and celery
- 1 1/2 cups creamy chicken gravy
- 1 1/2 tsp thyme and sage
- 1/4 cup parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the cooked chicken dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and peas, carrots, and celery until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the thyme and sage, then add the creamy chicken gravy. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the parsley. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Honey Mustard Chicken Thighs

*Roasted chicken thighs with honey-Dijon glaze, green beans, and rosemary.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
25-75 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb bone-in chicken thighs
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or olive oil
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups green beans and shallots
- 1 1/2 cups honey mustard glaze
- 1 1/2 tsp rosemary and garlic
- 1/4 cup parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked poultry up to 4 days.
- Swap: Chicken thighs and breasts can often substitute for each other with adjusted cooking time.
- Cook's tip: Use an instant-read thermometer; poultry is safely cooked at 165 F in the thickest part.

## METHOD

1. Pat the bone-in chicken thighs dry and season evenly with salt and pepper. Dry surfaces brown better and reduce splattering.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, presentation-side down first, then transfer to a plate.
3. Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion, garlic, and green beans and shallots until the onion is soft and the vegetables begin to color.
4. Stir in the rosemary and garlic, then add the honey mustard glaze. Scrape the bottom of the pan so the browned bits dissolve into the sauce.
5. Return the chicken and any juices. Simmer gently, turning once, until the thickest piece reaches 165 F and the sauce is reduced to a glossy consistency.
6. Rest the chicken for 5 minutes, then finish with the parsley. Serve with rice, potatoes, noodles, or bread to catch the sauce.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Peppercorn Beef Tips

*Browned beef tips with cracked pepper, mushrooms, shallots, and a creamy pan sauce.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb beef sirloin tips
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups shallots and mushrooms
- 2 cups cream and beef-stock pan sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp cracked black pepper
- 1/4 cup parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the beef sirloin tips dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and shallots and mushrooms until softened, then stir in the cracked black pepper for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the cream and beef-stock pan sauce and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the parsley.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Beef Bourguignon

*Slow-braised beef with red wine, mushrooms, pearl onions, carrots, and thyme.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb beef chuck cubes
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups mushrooms, carrots, and pearl onions
- 2 cups red wine and beef stock
- 1 1/2 tsp thyme and bay leaf
- 1/4 cup parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the beef chuck cubes dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and mushrooms, carrots, and pearl onions until softened, then stir in the thyme and bay leaf for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the red wine and beef stock and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the parsley.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Tomato Herb Beef Meatballs

*Tender beef meatballs with onion, herbs, tomato sauce, and grated carrot.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb beef meatballs
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups onion and grated carrot
- 2 cups tomato sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp garlic and thyme
- 1/4 cup chopped parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the beef meatballs dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and onion and grated carrot until softened, then stir in the garlic and thyme for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the tomato sauce and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the chopped parsley.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Lamb Kofta in Yogurt Sauce

*Spiced lamb kofta simmered briefly with a garlicky yogurt sauce, tomato, cumin, and herbs.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb formed lamb kofta logs
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups tomato and onion
- 2 cups garlic cucumber yogurt sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin and coriander
- 1/4 cup mint and parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the formed lamb kofta logs dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and tomato and onion until softened, then stir in the cumin and coriander for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the garlic cucumber yogurt sauce and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the mint and parsley.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Paprika Pork Medallions

*Seared pork medallions with paprika, lemon-caper butter, cabbage, and parsley.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork tenderloin medallions
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups cabbage and onion
- 2 cups lemon caper butter sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp paprika and black pepper
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the pork tenderloin medallions dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and cabbage and onion until softened, then stir in the paprika and black pepper for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the lemon caper butter sauce and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the parsley and lemon.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Citrus Pork Carnitas

*Slow-cooked pork shoulder with orange, lime, cumin, and crisped edges.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork shoulder cubes
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups onion and poblano pepper
- 2 cups orange-lime braising juices
- 1 1/2 tsp cumin and oregano
- 1/4 cup cilantro and lime

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the pork shoulder cubes dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and onion and poblano pepper until softened, then stir in the cumin and oregano for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the orange-lime braising juices and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the cilantro and lime.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Smoky Pulled Pork

*Low-and-slow pork shoulder with paprika, brown sugar, vinegar, and barbecue sauce.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork shoulder
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups onion and bell pepper
- 2 cups smoky barbecue braising sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp smoked paprika and mustard
- 1/4 cup pickles and scallions

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the pork shoulder dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and onion and bell pepper until softened, then stir in the smoked paprika and mustard for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the smoky barbecue braising sauce and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the pickles and scallions.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lamb and Vegetable Gravy Skillet

*Ground lamb, peas, carrots, rosemary, and thyme in a rich savory gravy.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb ground lamb formed into small patties
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups peas and carrots
- 2 cups savory lamb gravy
- 1 1/2 tsp rosemary and thyme
- 1/4 cup parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the ground lamb formed into small patties dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and peas and carrots until softened, then stir in the rosemary and thyme for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the savory lamb gravy and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the parsley.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Korean-Style Beef and Mushroom Skillet

*Beef, mushrooms, onion, soy, pear, ginger, sesame, and scallions in a glossy skillet sauce.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb beef sirloin strips
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups onion and mushrooms
- 2 cups soy pear sauce
- 1 1/2 tsp ginger and sesame
- 1/4 cup scallions and sesame seeds

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the beef sirloin strips dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and onion and mushrooms until softened, then stir in the ginger and sesame for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the soy pear sauce and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the scallions and sesame seeds.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Apricot Lamb Tagine

*Slow-braised lamb with apricots, chickpeas, cinnamon, cumin, and almonds.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
30 min-3 hr

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb lamb shoulder cubes
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups chickpeas and carrots
- 2 cups spiced stock with dried apricots
- 1 1/2 tsp cinnamon and cumin
- 1/4 cup toasted almonds and cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; most braises freeze well.
- Swap: Choose cuts with similar fat and connective tissue when substituting.
- Cook's tip: Rest whole cuts before slicing so juices redistribute; braises benefit from resting overnight.

## METHOD

1. Pat the lamb shoulder cubes dry and season with salt and pepper. Let it stand at room temperature for 15 minutes while you prepare the vegetables.
2. Heat the oil in a heavy pot or skillet. Brown the meat well on multiple sides; deep browning is the main source of savory flavor in the finished dish.
3. Remove the meat. Cook the onion, garlic, and chickpeas and carrots until softened, then stir in the cinnamon and cumin for 30 seconds.
4. Pour in the spiced stock with dried apricots and scrape up the browned bits. Return the meat and reduce the heat so the liquid bubbles gently rather than boiling hard.
5. Cook until the meat is tender and reaches a safe internal temperature for the cut. For braises, continue until a fork slides in easily and connective tissue has softened.
6. Rest the meat before slicing or shredding. Reduce the sauce if needed, taste for salt, and finish with the toasted almonds and cilantro.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Crispy-Skin Lemon Salmon

*Pan-seared salmon with crisp skin, lemon butter, asparagus, and dill.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb skin-on salmon fillets
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups asparagus
- 1 cup lemon butter sauce
- 1 tsp garlic and dill
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup fresh dill and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the skin-on salmon fillets very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and asparagus. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the lemon butter sauce and garlic and dill. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the fresh dill and lemon and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Mediterranean Cod Skillet

*Cod cooked with tomatoes, olives, capers, garlic, and oregano in a bright skillet sauce.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb cod fillets
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups cherry tomatoes and zucchini
- 1 cup tomato olive pan sauce
- 1 tsp oregano and garlic
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the cod fillets very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and cherry tomatoes and zucchini. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the tomato olive pan sauce and oregano and garlic. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the parsley and lemon and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Garlic Shrimp Scampi

*Shrimp in garlic butter, white wine, lemon, parsley, and chili.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb large peeled shrimp
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups cherry tomatoes
- 1 cup garlic white-wine butter sauce
- 1 tsp chili flakes and garlic
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the large peeled shrimp very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and cherry tomatoes. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the garlic white-wine butter sauce and chili flakes and garlic. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the parsley and lemon and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Baja Lime Fish Skillet

*Spiced white fish with cabbage, tomato, cumin, chili, lime crema, and cilantro.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb firm white fish fillets
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups cabbage and tomato
- 1 cup lime crema
- 1 tsp cumin and chili powder
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup cilantro and lime

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the firm white fish fillets very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and cabbage and tomato. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the lime crema and cumin and chili powder. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the cilantro and lime and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Old Bay Shrimp and Corn Skillet

*Shrimp with corn, celery, scallions, lemon-mustard sauce, and Old Bay-style seasoning.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb peeled shrimp
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups corn, celery, and scallions
- 1 cup lemon mustard pan sauce
- 1 tsp Old Bay-style seasoning
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the peeled shrimp very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and corn, celery, and scallions. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the lemon mustard pan sauce and Old Bay-style seasoning. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the parsley and lemon and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Garlic White Wine Scallops

*Seared scallops with white wine, tomato, garlic, chili, butter, and parsley.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb large sea scallops
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups cherry tomatoes
- 1 cup white wine tomato sauce
- 1 tsp garlic and chili flakes
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup parsley and lemon

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the large sea scallops very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and cherry tomatoes. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the white wine tomato sauce and garlic and chili flakes. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the parsley and lemon and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Sesame Crusted Tuna

*Quick-seared tuna with sesame crust, cucumber, soy-lime sauce, and scallions.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb tuna steaks
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups cucumber ribbons
- 1 cup soy lime sauce
- 1 tsp sesame and black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup scallions and sesame

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the tuna steaks very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and cucumber ribbons. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the soy lime sauce and sesame and black pepper. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the scallions and sesame and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Creamy Salmon and Corn Skillet

*Salmon with corn, potatoes, thyme, chives, and a light seafood cream sauce.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb salmon fillets
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups par-cooked potatoes and corn
- 1 cup cream and seafood-stock sauce
- 1 tsp thyme and black pepper
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup chives and parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the salmon fillets very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and par-cooked potatoes and corn. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the cream and seafood-stock sauce and thyme and black pepper. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the chives and parsley and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Citrus Chili Shrimp Skillet

*Quick-cooked shrimp with tomato, cucumber, red onion, citrus, chili, avocado, and cilantro.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb peeled shrimp
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups tomato and red onion
- 1 cup lime and orange pan sauce
- 1 tsp chili and cumin
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup cilantro and avocado

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the peeled shrimp very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and tomato and red onion. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the lime and orange pan sauce and chili and cumin. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the cilantro and avocado and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Maple Miso Salmon Skillet

*Salmon with a maple-miso glaze, bok choy, sesame, and scallions in a quick skillet meal.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-30 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 lb salmon fillets
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil or butter
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 cups bok choy
- 1 cup maple miso glaze
- 1 tsp ginger and sesame
- 1 tbsp lemon or lime juice
- 1/4 cup scallions and sesame seeds

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate cooked seafood 2 to 3 days; raw-style preparations are best the same day.
- Swap: Use another seafood with similar thickness and texture.
- Cook's tip: Seafood cooks quickly; remove it just as it turns opaque or flakes easily to avoid dryness.

## METHOD

1. Pat the salmon fillets very dry and season with salt and pepper. If using fish with skin, score the skin lightly so it stays flat in the pan.
2. Heat the oil or butter in a wide skillet over medium-high heat. Add the seafood in a single layer and cook without moving until well browned on the first side.
3. Turn carefully, lower the heat to medium, and add the garlic and bok choy. Cook until the vegetables are crisp-tender and the seafood is almost done.
4. Add the maple miso glaze and ginger and sesame. Simmer briefly, spooning the sauce over the seafood; avoid prolonged cooking once fish flakes or shrimp turn opaque.
5. Finish with lemon or lime juice. Taste the sauce and adjust salt, acidity, or heat as needed.
6. Scatter with the scallions and sesame seeds and serve immediately. Seafood is best when it goes from pan to plate without a long holding period.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Thai Green Curry

*Fragrant coconut curry with chicken or tofu, eggplant, basil, lime, and green curry paste.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp green curry paste
- 3 cups chicken or firm tofu
- 2 cups Thai eggplant and bell pepper
- 2 cups coconut milk and stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lime juice
- 1/3 cup Thai basil and cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and green curry paste. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the chicken or firm tofu and Thai eggplant and bell pepper. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the coconut milk and stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lime juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the Thai basil and cilantro. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Japanese Curry

*Mild thick curry with beef or tofu, potato, carrot, onion, and warm spices.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp Japanese curry powder or roux
- 3 cups beef cubes or firm tofu
- 2 cups potatoes and carrots
- 2 cups beef or vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp rice vinegar
- 1/3 cup scallions

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and Japanese curry powder or roux. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the beef cubes or firm tofu and potatoes and carrots. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the beef or vegetable stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the rice vinegar at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the scallions. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chana Masala

*Chickpeas simmered with tomato, onion, ginger, cumin, coriander, and garam masala.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp chana masala or garam masala
- 3 cups cooked chickpeas
- 2 cups diced tomatoes
- 2 cups crushed tomatoes and water
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1/3 cup cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and chana masala or garam masala. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the cooked chickpeas and diced tomatoes. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the crushed tomatoes and water, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lemon juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the cilantro. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chicken Korma

*Gentle spiced chicken in a creamy yogurt, cashew, cardamom, and onion sauce.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp korma spice blend
- 3 cups boneless chicken thighs
- 2 cups peas or cauliflower
- 2 cups yogurt cashew sauce
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1/3 cup cilantro and toasted cashews

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and korma spice blend. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the boneless chicken thighs and peas or cauliflower. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the yogurt cashew sauce, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lemon juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the cilantro and toasted cashews. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Thai Red Curry with Shrimp

*Shrimp, peppers, bamboo shoots, coconut milk, basil, and red curry paste.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp red curry paste
- 3 cups peeled shrimp
- 2 cups bell pepper and bamboo shoots
- 2 cups coconut milk and stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lime juice
- 1/3 cup Thai basil

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and red curry paste. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the peeled shrimp and bell pepper and bamboo shoots. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the coconut milk and stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lime juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the Thai basil. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Ethiopian-Style Misir Wot

*Red lentils cooked with onion, garlic, tomato, and berbere spice until deeply savory.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp berbere spice
- 3 cups red lentils
- 2 cups diced tomatoes
- 2 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1/3 cup cilantro or parsley

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and berbere spice. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the red lentils and diced tomatoes. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the vegetable stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lemon juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the cilantro or parsley. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Brazilian-Inspired Moqueca

*Coconut seafood stew with peppers, tomato, lime, cilantro, and paprika.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp smoked paprika and chili
- 3 cups firm white fish and shrimp
- 2 cups bell peppers and tomato
- 2 cups coconut milk and seafood stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lime juice
- 1/3 cup cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and smoked paprika and chili. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the firm white fish and shrimp and bell peppers and tomato. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the coconut milk and seafood stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lime juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the cilantro. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Persian-Style Herb Bean Stew

*Beans and greens simmered with herbs, dried lime, turmeric, and onion.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp turmeric and dried lime
- 3 cups cooked kidney beans
- 2 cups spinach and mixed herbs
- 2 cups vegetable stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1/3 cup parsley and scallions

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and turmeric and dried lime. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the cooked kidney beans and spinach and mixed herbs. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the vegetable stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lemon juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the parsley and scallions. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Malaysian-Inspired Coconut Curry

*Spicy coconut curry with shrimp or tofu, bok choy, bean sprouts, herbs, and lime.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp laksa curry paste
- 3 cups shrimp or tofu
- 2 cups bean sprouts and bok choy
- 2 cups coconut milk and stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp lime juice
- 1/3 cup cilantro and mint

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and laksa curry paste. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the shrimp or tofu and bean sprouts and bok choy. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the coconut milk and stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the lime juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the cilantro and mint. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Tamarind Pork or Tofu Curry

*A tangy tamarind one-pot with pork or tofu, tomato, radish, greens, and beans.*

**PREP**  
20 min

**COOK**  
30-60 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 2 tbsp tamarind curry paste
- 3 cups pork shoulder or firm tofu
- 2 cups radish, tomato, and green beans
- 2 cups water or light stock
- 1 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp tamarind or lime juice
- 1/3 cup scallions and cilantro

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate 3 to 4 days; many curries improve overnight.
- Swap: Adjust chili separately from the aromatic spices so heat does not overpower flavor.
- Cook's tip: Bloom spice pastes in oil before adding liquid to release fat-soluble aromas.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a heavy pot over medium heat. Cook the onion with a pinch of salt until soft and golden at the edges, 7 to 9 minutes.
2. Add the garlic, ginger, and tamarind curry paste. Cook for 45 seconds, stirring constantly, until fragrant and the spices darken slightly.
3. Add the pork shoulder or firm tofu and radish, tomato, and green beans. Stir well so everything is coated in the spice mixture.
4. Pour in the water or light stock, add the salt, and bring to a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered or partially covered until the main ingredient is tender and the sauce thickens.
5. Stir in the tamarind or lime juice at the end to sharpen the flavors. Taste and adjust salt, spice, and sweetness if needed.
6. Finish with the scallions and cilantro. Serve with rice, flatbread, noodles, or a crisp salad depending on the style of curry.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Rosemary Sea Salt Focaccia

*Airy olive-oil bread with a crisp base, dimples, rosemary, and flaky salt.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups bread flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm water
- 2 1/4 tsp active dry yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 2 tbsp chopped rosemary
- extra flour or oil for shaping

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm water, active dry yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the bread flour, salt, extra-virgin olive oil, and 2 tbsp chopped rosemary until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into a dimpled sheet-pan loaf. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 425 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Garlic Butter Naan

*Soft blistered flatbreads brushed with garlic butter and herbs.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm milk or water
- 2 1/4 tsp instant yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp melted butter or ghee
- 1/2 cup plain yogurt
- extra flour or oil for shaping

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm milk or water, instant yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the all-purpose flour, salt, melted butter or ghee, and 1/2 cup plain yogurt until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into 8 oval flatbreads. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 475 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Whole Wheat Pita

*Pocketed flatbread with nutty whole-wheat flavor and a soft chewy crumb.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups whole-wheat and all-purpose flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm water
- 2 1/4 tsp active dry yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp sesame seeds
- extra flour or oil for shaping

### NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm water, active dry yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the whole-wheat and all-purpose flour, salt, olive oil, and 2 tbsp sesame seeds until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into 8 small rounds. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 475 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

### SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Honey Brioche

*Rich, tender bread with eggs, butter, honey, and a glossy crust.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups bread flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm milk
- 2 1/4 tsp instant yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp softened butter
- 2 beaten eggs plus 3 tbsp honey
- extra flour or oil for shaping

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm milk, instant yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the bread flour, salt, softened butter, and 2 beaten eggs plus 3 tbsp honey until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into one braided loaf. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 375 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cinnamon Banana Bread

*Moist banana loaf with cinnamon, brown sugar, and walnuts.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 1/2 cups very ripe mashed banana
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1/2 cup melted butter
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line or grease a standard loaf pan. Whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder, salt, and spice in a bowl.
2. In a second bowl, mash or prepare the very ripe mashed banana, then whisk with the brown sugar, eggs, melted butter, and vanilla until evenly combined.
3. Fold the dry ingredients into the wet just until no dry pockets remain. Overmixing develops gluten and can make the loaf tough.
4. Fold in most of the chopped walnuts, reserving a little for the top. Scrape the batter into the pan and level it gently.
5. Bake until the loaf is deeply golden and a tester inserted in the center comes out with only a few moist crumbs, 50 to 65 minutes.
6. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes, then transfer to a rack. Slice only after it has cooled enough to set cleanly.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Jalapeno Cheddar Cornbread

*Tender skillet cornbread with cheddar, jalapeno, corn, and honey.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cornmeal and all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 1/2 cups corn kernels and chopped jalapeno
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1/2 cup melted butter
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup shredded cheddar

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line or grease a standard loaf pan. Whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder, salt, and spice in a bowl.
2. In a second bowl, mash or prepare the corn kernels and chopped jalapeno, then whisk with the brown sugar, eggs, melted butter, and vanilla until evenly combined.
3. Fold the dry ingredients into the wet just until no dry pockets remain. Overmixing develops gluten and can make the loaf tough.
4. Fold in most of the shredded cheddar, reserving a little for the top. Scrape the batter into the pan and level it gently.
5. Bake until the loaf is deeply golden and a tester inserted in the center comes out with only a few moist crumbs, 50 to 65 minutes.
6. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes, then transfer to a rack. Slice only after it has cooled enough to set cleanly.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Homemade Sesame Bagels

*Chewy boiled bagels with a crisp crust and sesame topping.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups bread flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm water
- 2 1/4 tsp instant yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp neutral oil
- 3 tbsp sesame seeds
- extra flour or oil for shaping

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm water, instant yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the bread flour, salt, neutral oil, and 3 tbsp sesame seeds until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into 8 bagel rings. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 425 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Cinnamon Rolls

Soft enriched rolls with cinnamon-brown sugar filling and vanilla glaze.

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm milk
- 2 1/4 tsp active dry yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp softened butter
- 3/4 cup cinnamon brown sugar filling
- extra flour or oil for shaping

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm milk, active dry yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the all-purpose flour, salt, softened butter, and 3/4 cup cinnamon brown sugar filling until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into 12 spiral rolls. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 375 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Blueberry Lemon Quick Bread

*Tender lemon loaf filled with blueberries and finished with a light sugar crust.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1 tsp ground cardamom
- 1 1/2 cups fresh blueberries and lemon zest
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1/2 cup melted butter
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup coarse sugar

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line or grease a standard loaf pan. Whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder, salt, and spice in a bowl.
2. In a second bowl, mash or prepare the fresh blueberries and lemon zest, then whisk with the brown sugar, eggs, melted butter, and vanilla until evenly combined.
3. Fold the dry ingredients into the wet just until no dry pockets remain. Overmixing develops gluten and can make the loaf tough.
4. Fold in most of the coarse sugar, reserving a little for the top. Scrape the batter into the pan and level it gently.
5. Bake until the loaf is deeply golden and a tester inserted in the center comes out with only a few moist crumbs, 50 to 65 minutes.
6. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes, then transfer to a rack. Slice only after it has cooled enough to set cleanly.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Everyday Pizza Dough

*Flexible pizza dough with good chew, flavor, and enough structure for high-heat baking.*

**PREP**

20-30 min + rise

**COOK**

15-35 min

**SERVES**

1 loaf or 8-12 pieces

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 1/2 cups bread flour
- 1 1/4 cups warm water
- 2 1/4 tsp instant yeast
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- 1 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp honey
- extra flour or oil for shaping

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store bread airtight 2 days or freeze well wrapped up to 2 months.
- Swap: Bread flour gives more chew; all-purpose flour can work with slightly less liquid.
- Cook's tip: Judge proofing by volume and feel, not only by the clock; room temperature changes rise time.

## METHOD

1. Combine the warm water, instant yeast, and sugar. Let stand for 5 to 10 minutes until foamy; if nothing happens, the yeast may be inactive or the liquid too hot.
2. Mix in the bread flour, salt, olive oil, and 1 tbsp honey until a shaggy dough forms. Knead 8 to 10 minutes by hand or 6 to 7 minutes with a dough hook until smooth and elastic.
3. Place in a lightly oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until roughly doubled, 60 to 90 minutes depending on room temperature.
4. Degas gently and shape into two 12-inch pizza rounds. Cover and proof again until visibly puffy and an indentation springs back slowly, 30 to 50 minutes.
5. Bake in a fully preheated 500 F oven until deeply golden and the center sounds hollow when tapped. Rich or thick breads may need a slightly lower temperature and longer bake.
6. Cool on a rack before slicing so steam can redistribute. Store airtight once completely cool; rewarm briefly in the oven for a fresh-baked texture.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Margherita Pizza

*Tomato, fresh mozzarella, basil, and olive oil on a blistered thin crust.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup crushed tomato sauce
- 2 cups fresh mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups sliced tomatoes
- 1 cup Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the crushed tomato sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the fresh mozzarella, sliced tomatoes, and Parmesan in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh basil, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Pepperoni Hot Honey Pizza

*Crisp pepperoni, mozzarella, tomato sauce, chili, and a drizzle of hot honey.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup tomato pizza sauce
- 2 cups low-moisture mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups pepperoni
- 1 cup thin sliced red onion
- 1/4 cup fresh oregano
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the tomato pizza sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the low-moisture mozzarella, pepperoni, and thin sliced red onion in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh oregano, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# White Mushroom Pizza

*Garlic ricotta, mozzarella, mushrooms, Parmesan, and thyme without tomato sauce.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup garlic ricotta sauce
- 2 cups mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups sauteed mushrooms
- 1 cup Parmesan
- 1/4 cup fresh thyme
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the garlic ricotta sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the mozzarella, sauteed mushrooms, and Parmesan in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh thyme, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Spinach Ricotta White Pizza

*Creamy ricotta, spinach, mozzarella, garlic, and basil on a crisp crust.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup tomato sauce for dipping
- 2 cups ricotta and mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups sauteed spinach
- 1 cup roasted garlic
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the tomato sauce for dipping, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the ricotta and mozzarella, sauteed spinach, and roasted garlic in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh basil, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Bacon Gruyere Pizza

*Crisp pizza with garlic cream sauce, Gruyere, bacon, caramelized onion, and chives.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup garlic cream sauce
- 2 cups Gruyere
- 1 1/2 cups cooked bacon
- 1 cup caramelized onion
- 1/4 cup fresh chives
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the garlic cream sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the Gruyere, cooked bacon, and caramelized onion in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh chives, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Spinach Feta Flatbread

*A crisp flatbread with garlic yogurt sauce, feta, spinach, scallions, and dill.*

**PREP**

20-30 min

**COOK**

10-45 min

**SERVES**

4-6

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup garlic yogurt sauce
- 2 cups crumbled feta
- 1 1/2 cups sauteed spinach
- 1 cup scallions
- 1/4 cup fresh dill
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the garlic yogurt sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the crumbled feta, sauteed spinach, and scallions in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh dill, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Spiced Beef and Olive Pizza

*Tomato pizza with spiced beef, olives, mozzarella, onion, and parsley.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup tomato pizza sauce
- 2 cups mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups spiced ground beef
- 1 cup green olives and onion
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the tomato pizza sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the mozzarella, spiced ground beef, and green olives and onion in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh parsley, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Sausage Mustard Pizza

*Pizza with mustard cream sauce, sausage, mozzarella, caramelized onion, and parsley.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup Dijon cream sauce
- 2 cups mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups cooked crumbled sausage
- 1 cup caramelized onion
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the Dijon cream sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the mozzarella, cooked crumbled sausage, and caramelized onion in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh parsley, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Tomato Goat Cheese Pizza

*Pizza with Dijon cream, goat cheese, tomatoes, caramelized onion, and thyme.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup Dijon cream sauce
- 2 cups goat cheese and mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups sliced tomatoes
- 1 cup caramelized onion
- 1/4 cup fresh thyme
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the Dijon cream sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the goat cheese and mozzarella, sliced tomatoes, and caramelized onion in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh thyme, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Italian Deli Pizza

*Pizza with marinara, provolone, mozzarella, salami, ham, roasted peppers, and basil.*

**PREP**  
20-30 min

**COOK**  
10-45 min

**SERVES**  
4-6

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pizza dough
- 2 tbsp flour or semolina for dusting
- 3/4 cup marinara sauce
- 2 cups provolone and mozzarella
- 1 1/2 cups salami and ham
- 1 cup roasted peppers
- 1/4 cup fresh basil
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- pinch of chili flakes, optional

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate baked leftovers 3 days and reheat in a hot oven.
- Swap: Swap toppings, but avoid overloading with wet ingredients.
- Cook's tip: Preheat the baking surface thoroughly; bottom heat is key to crisp pastry and pizza crust.

## METHOD

1. Place a pizza stone or inverted heavy baking sheet in the oven and heat to 500 F for at least 30 minutes. High heat gives the crust better rise and browning.
2. Stretch the pizza dough on a lightly floured surface into a 12-inch round. Keep the rim slightly thicker and avoid crushing all the gas from the edge.
3. Spread on the marinara sauce, leaving a 1/2-inch border. Add the provolone and mozzarella, salami and ham, and roasted peppers in an even but not overloaded layer.
4. Slide the pizza onto the preheated surface and bake until the crust is blistered and the cheese is bubbling, usually 7 to 11 minutes.
5. Finish with the fresh basil, olive oil, salt, and chili flakes if using. Let the pizza rest for 2 minutes before cutting so the cheese settles.
6. For a crisper bottom, return individual slices directly to the oven rack for 1 to 2 minutes before serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Hummus

*Silky chickpea dip with tahini, lemon, garlic, cumin, and olive oil.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cooked chickpeas
- 1 cup tahini
- 2 tbsp lemon juice
- 1 small garlic clove, grated
- 1/4 cup parsley
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- water as needed for texture

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. If needed, cook or drain the cooked chickpeas thoroughly. Excess moisture can make the finished dip thin and bland.
2. Add the cooked chickpeas, tahini, lemon juice, garlic, parsley, ground cumin, salt, and pepper to a food processor or mixing bowl.
3. Blend or mash until the desired texture is reached. For a rustic dip, leave some small pieces; for a smooth sauce, blend longer.
4. Stream in the olive oil. If the dip is too thick, add cool water 1 tablespoon at a time until creamy and scoopable.
5. Taste and correct the balance: more salt for savoriness, acid for brightness, or a pinch of sugar if the flavor is overly sharp.
6. Chill for 20 minutes before serving when possible. Bring thick refrigerated dips back toward room temperature so their flavor and texture open up.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Chunky Guacamole

*Creamy avocado with lime, onion, tomato, cilantro, and jalapeno.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups ripe avocados
- 1 cup diced tomato
- 2 tbsp lime juice
- 1 small garlic clove, grated
- 1/4 cup cilantro
- 1 tsp minced jalapeno
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- water as needed for texture

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. If needed, cook or drain the ripe avocados thoroughly. Excess moisture can make the finished dip thin and bland.
2. Add the ripe avocados, diced tomato, lime juice, garlic, cilantro, minced jalapeno, salt, and pepper to a food processor or mixing bowl.
3. Blend or mash until the desired texture is reached. For a rustic dip, leave some small pieces; for a smooth sauce, blend longer.
4. Stream in the olive oil. If the dip is too thick, add cool water 1 tablespoon at a time until creamy and scoopable.
5. Taste and correct the balance: more salt for savoriness, acid for brightness, or a pinch of sugar if the flavor is overly sharp.
6. Chill for 20 minutes before serving when possible. Bring thick refrigerated dips back toward room temperature so their flavor and texture open up.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Zucchini Corn Fritters

*Crisp vegetable fritters with zucchini, corn, herbs, and a tangy balsamic tomato dip.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups grated squeezed zucchini and corn
- 1 cup grated Parmesan
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp garlic and black pepper
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup balsamic tomato dip, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the grated squeezed zucchini and corn so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the grated Parmesan, egg or plant binder, garlic and black pepper, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the balsamic tomato dip. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cabbage Carrot Vegetable Patties

*Crisp patties with cabbage, carrot, mushrooms, scallion, ginger, and sweet chili dip.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups shredded cabbage, carrot, and mushrooms
- 1 cup mashed potato
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp ginger and five-spice
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup sweet chili dipping sauce, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the shredded cabbage, carrot, and mushrooms so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the mashed potato, egg or plant binder, ginger and five-spice, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the sweet chili dipping sauce. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Spiced Potato Pea Croquettes

*Crisp potato and pea croquettes with garam masala, cumin, herbs, and mint chutney.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups mashed potato and peas
- 1 cup grated mild cheese
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp garam masala and cumin
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup mint chutney, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the mashed potato and peas so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the grated mild cheese, egg or plant binder, garam masala and cumin, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the mint chutney. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Mozzarella Arancini

*Crisp risotto balls with mozzarella centers, Parmesan, herbs, and marinara.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups cold cooked risotto
- 1 cup grated Parmesan and mozzarella cubes
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup marinara sauce, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the cold cooked risotto so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the grated Parmesan and mozzarella cubes, egg or plant binder, Italian seasoning, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the marinara sauce. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Smoky Chickpea Patties

*Savory chickpea patties with mustard, herbs, smoked paprika, and a tangy pickle dip.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups mashed chickpeas
- 1 cup mayonnaise and Dijon or vegan mayo
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup hot sauce or pickle relish, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the mashed chickpeas so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the mayonnaise and Dijon or vegan mayo, egg or plant binder, smoked paprika, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the hot sauce or pickle relish. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Spinach Artichoke Dip

*Hot creamy dip with spinach, artichokes, cream cheese, Parmesan, and garlic.*

**PREP**  
15-30 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups chopped artichoke hearts and spinach
- 1 cup cream cheese and Greek yogurt
- 2 tbsp lemon juice
- 1 small garlic clove, grated
- 1/4 cup chopped parsley
- 1 tsp garlic and chili flakes
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- water as needed for texture

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. If needed, cook or drain the chopped artichoke hearts and spinach thoroughly. Excess moisture can make the finished dip thin and bland.
2. Add the chopped artichoke hearts and spinach, cream cheese and Greek yogurt, lemon juice, garlic, chopped parsley, garlic and chili flakes, salt, and pepper to a food processor or mixing bowl.
3. Blend or mash until the desired texture is reached. For a rustic dip, leave some small pieces; for a smooth sauce, blend longer.
4. Stream in the olive oil. If the dip is too thick, add cool water 1 tablespoon at a time until creamy and scoopable.
5. Taste and correct the balance: more salt for savoriness, acid for brightness, or a pinch of sugar if the flavor is overly sharp.
6. Chill for 20 minutes before serving when possible. Bring thick refrigerated dips back toward room temperature so their flavor and texture open up.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Buffalo Cauliflower Fritters

*Crisp cauliflower fritters seasoned with garlic and paprika, served with buffalo ranch dip.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups finely chopped cooked cauliflower
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp garlic powder and paprika
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup buffalo ranch dip, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the finely chopped cooked cauliflower so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the shredded cheddar, egg or plant binder, garlic powder and paprika, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the buffalo ranch dip. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Crispy Ham and Cheese Croquettes

*Creamy potato croquettes with ham, cheese, herbs, and a crunchy crust.*

**PREP**

15-30 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

6-8 appetizer portions

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups chilled mashed potatoes and diced ham
- 1 cup shredded cheese
- 1 large egg or 2 tbsp plant-based binder
- 1 tsp mustard and paprika
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh herbs
- 1/2 cup breadcrumbs or flour, as needed
- 1 cup herb mayonnaise, for serving
- oil for cooking

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most dips keep 3 to 4 days; fried items are best fresh.
- Swap: Scale appetizers by portioning smaller or larger rather than changing seasoning ratios dramatically.
- Cook's tip: For crisp foods, drain or cool on a rack instead of paper towels whenever possible.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the chilled mashed potatoes and diced ham so it is dry enough to hold together; squeeze out excess liquid or let hot ingredients cool before mixing.
2. Combine with the shredded cheese, egg or plant binder, mustard and paprika, salt, pepper, and herbs. Add just enough breadcrumbs or flour for the mixture to hold its shape.
3. Shape into bite-size portions with lightly damp hands. Chill for 15 minutes if the mixture feels soft; this makes cooking easier.
4. Cook in a 425 F oven, a skillet, or a shallow layer of oil until crisp and deeply golden on the outside and hot in the center, turning as needed for even browning.
5. Let the appetizers rest on a rack for 2 to 3 minutes so the crust stays crisp. Season lightly while still hot.
6. Serve with the herb mayonnaise. For parties, keep warm in a low oven and replenish the serving platter in small batches.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Basil Pesto

*Fresh basil, Parmesan, pine nuts, garlic, lemon, and olive oil.*

**PREP**

10-15 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

1-2 cups

**LEVEL**

Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups fresh basil leaves
- 1/4 cup lemon juice
- 2 tbsp grated Parmesan
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup toasted pine nuts
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the fresh basil leaves, lemon juice, grated Parmesan, garlic, black pepper, toasted pine nuts, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Argentinian-Style Chimichurri

*Parsley, oregano, garlic, red wine vinegar, chili, and olive oil.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flat-leaf parsley
- 1/4 cup red wine vinegar
- 2 tbsp a pinch of sugar
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp red pepper flakes
- 1/3 cup fresh oregano
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the flat-leaf parsley, red wine vinegar, a pinch of sugar, garlic, red pepper flakes, fresh oregano, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Roasted Red Pepper Romesco

*Smoky roasted pepper sauce with almonds, tomato, garlic, paprika, and sherry vinegar.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups roasted red peppers and tomato
- 1/4 cup sherry vinegar
- 2 tbsp honey
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/3 cup toasted almonds and parsley
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the roasted red peppers and tomato, sherry vinegar, honey, garlic, smoked paprika, toasted almonds and parsley, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cucumber Dill Tzatziki

Cool yogurt sauce with cucumber, dill, garlic, lemon, and olive oil.

**PREP**

10-15 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

1-2 cups

**LEVEL**

Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups grated squeezed cucumber
- 1/4 cup lemon juice
- 2 tbsp plain Greek yogurt
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup fresh dill
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the grated squeezed cucumber, lemon juice, plain Greek yogurt, garlic, black pepper, fresh dill, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Roasted Garlic Herb Dressing

*Creamy garlic dressing with lemon, Dijon, herbs, black pepper, and olive oil.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups roasted garlic and Greek yogurt
- 1/4 cup lemon juice
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup chopped parsley
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the roasted garlic and Greek yogurt, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, garlic, black pepper, chopped parsley, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Tomatillo Salsa Verde

Bright salsa of tomatillos, jalapeno, onion, lime, cilantro, and garlic.

**PREP**

10-15 min

**COOK**

0-30 min

**SERVES**

1-2 cups

**LEVEL**

Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups roasted tomatillos
- 1/4 cup lime juice
- 2 tbsp a pinch of sugar
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp jalapeno and cumin
- 1/3 cup cilantro
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the roasted tomatillos, lime juice, a pinch of sugar, garlic, jalapeno and cumin, cilantro, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Red Enchilada Sauce

*Smoky chile-tomato sauce with cumin, oregano, garlic, and stock.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups crushed tomatoes and mild chile puree
- 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar
- 2 tbsp brown sugar
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp cumin and chili powder
- 1/3 cup fresh oregano
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the crushed tomatoes and mild chile puree, apple cider vinegar, brown sugar, garlic, cumin and chili powder, fresh oregano, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Ginger Soy Glaze

*Glossy soy-ginger glaze balanced with brown sugar, rice vinegar, and sesame.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups soy sauce and water
- 1/4 cup rice vinegar
- 2 tbsp brown sugar or honey
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp grated ginger
- 1/3 cup scallions
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the soy sauce and water, rice vinegar, brown sugar or honey, garlic, grated ginger, scallions, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Smoky Barbecue Sauce

*Tomato-based barbecue sauce with molasses, vinegar, mustard, and smoked paprika.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups tomato ketchup or crushed tomatoes
- 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar
- 2 tbsp molasses and brown sugar
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp smoked paprika and mustard
- 1/3 cup chopped thyme
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the tomato ketchup or crushed tomatoes, apple cider vinegar, molasses and brown sugar, garlic, smoked paprika and mustard, chopped thyme, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Balsamic Herb Vinaigrette

*Bold balsamic dressing with Dijon, honey, thyme, black pepper, and olive oil.*

**PREP**  
10-15 min

**COOK**  
0-30 min

**SERVES**  
1-2 cups

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups Dijon mustard and balsamic-friendly aromatics
- 1/4 cup balsamic vinegar
- 2 tbsp honey
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1/3 cup fresh thyme
- 1/2 cup olive oil or neutral oil
- 3/4 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 to 4 tbsp water, as needed

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar; most sauces keep 4 to 7 days.
- Swap: Adjust acidity and sweetness gradually because flavors intensify as sauces rest.
- Cook's tip: Use a clean spoon each time to improve shelf life and prevent contamination.

## METHOD

1. Combine the Dijon mustard and balsamic-friendly aromatics, balsamic vinegar, honey, garlic, black pepper, fresh thyme, salt, and pepper in a blender or saucepan depending on the sauce style.
2. Blend until smooth, or simmer gently for 10 to 20 minutes if a cooked sauce is desired. Cooking mellows raw aromatics and concentrates sweetness.
3. Add the oil gradually while blending or whisking if the sauce benefits from emulsification; for cooked glazes, simply stir until glossy. If the sauce is too thick, loosen it with water a tablespoon at a time.
4. Taste for balance. A well-rounded sauce usually needs salt, acidity, sweetness, and enough fat or body to carry the flavor.
5. Strain only if a very smooth texture is wanted. Otherwise keep the sauce rustic for more texture and visual character.
6. Cool before storing. Refrigerate in a clean airtight jar and use a clean spoon each time to extend freshness.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Dark Chocolate Layer Cake

*Moist cocoa cake layered with glossy chocolate buttercream.*

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup neutral oil
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 cups chocolate buttercream

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the neutral oil until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, buttermilk, and vanilla extract separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the unsweetened cocoa powder. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the chocolate buttercream. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Vanilla Celebration Cake

*Tender vanilla cake with a soft crumb and vanilla buttercream.*

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cake flour or all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup whole milk
- 2 tsp vanilla bean paste
- 1/2 cup rainbow sprinkles
- 2 cups vanilla buttercream

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the cake flour or all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the unsalted butter until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, whole milk, and vanilla bean paste separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the rainbow sprinkles. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the vanilla buttercream. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Carrot Walnut Cake

*Spiced carrot cake with walnuts, pineapple, and tangy cream-cheese frosting.*

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup neutral oil
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon and vanilla
- 1/2 cup grated carrot, crushed pineapple, and walnuts
- 2 cups cream-cheese frosting

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the neutral oil until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, buttermilk, and ground cinnamon and vanilla separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the grated carrot, crushed pineapple, and walnuts. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the cream-cheese frosting. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lemon Drizzle Cake

Bright lemon cake soaked with lemon syrup and finished with a simple glaze.

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup whole milk
- 2 tsp lemon zest and vanilla
- 1/2 cup fresh lemon zest
- 2 cups lemon glaze

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the unsalted butter until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, whole milk, and lemon zest and vanilla separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the fresh lemon zest. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the lemon glaze. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Red Velvet Cake

*Cocoa-kissed red cake with buttermilk and classic cream-cheese frosting.*

**PREP**

25-40 min

**COOK**

35-75 min

**SERVES**

8-12

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup neutral oil
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 2 tsp vanilla and a small amount of cocoa
- 1/2 cup red gel coloring
- 2 cups cream-cheese frosting

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the neutral oil until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, buttermilk, and vanilla and a small amount of cocoa separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the red gel coloring. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the cream-cheese frosting. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Apple Cinnamon Layer Cake

*Tender apple-spice cake with cinnamon, brown sugar, and vanilla frosting.*

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup whole milk
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon and vanilla
- 1/2 cup finely diced apples
- 2 cups vanilla buttercream

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the unsalted butter until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, whole milk, and ground cinnamon and vanilla separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the finely diced apples. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the vanilla buttercream. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Maple Pecan Cake

*Buttery maple cake with toasted pecans and maple buttercream.*

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup whole milk
- 2 tsp maple extract and vanilla
- 1/2 cup toasted chopped pecans
- 2 cups maple buttercream

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the unsalted butter until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, whole milk, and maple extract and vanilla separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the toasted chopped pecans. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the maple buttercream. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Key Lime Coconut Cake

Bright lime cake with coconut, vanilla, and tangy lime frosting.

**PREP**

25-40 min

**COOK**

35-75 min

**SERVES**

8-12

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup coconut milk
- 2 tsp lime zest and vanilla
- 1/2 cup shredded coconut
- 2 cups lime buttercream

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the unsalted butter until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, coconut milk, and lime zest and vanilla separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the shredded coconut. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the lime buttercream. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Berry Almond Celebration Cake

*Soft almond-vanilla cake with berries and a light cream-cheese frosting.*

**PREP**

25-40 min

**COOK**

35-75 min

**SERVES**

8-12

**LEVEL**

Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup whole milk
- 2 tsp almond extract and vanilla
- 1/2 cup fresh mixed berries
- 2 cups cream-cheese frosting

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the unsalted butter until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, whole milk, and almond extract and vanilla separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the fresh mixed berries. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the cream-cheese frosting. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Chocolate Espresso Almond Cake

*Rich chocolate cake with espresso, almond flour, and glossy chocolate frosting.*

**PREP**  
25-40 min

**COOK**  
35-75 min

**SERVES**  
8-12

**LEVEL**  
Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour and almond flour
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/2 cup neutral oil
- 3 large eggs
- 1 cup strong coffee
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup unsweetened cocoa and chopped almonds
- 2 cups chocolate buttercream

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Most cakes keep about 3 days covered; refrigerate cakes with cream-cheese frosting.
- Swap: Room-temperature ingredients mix more evenly and give a finer crumb.
- Cook's tip: Cool cakes completely before frosting; structure develops as the crumb cools.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F. Grease two 8-inch round pans and line the bottoms with parchment for reliable release.
2. Whisk the all-purpose flour and almond flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Beat in the neutral oil until the mixture resembles fine crumbs; coating the flour with fat helps create a tender crumb.
3. Whisk the eggs, strong coffee, and vanilla extract separately. Add to the dry mixture in two or three additions, mixing only until smooth.
4. Fold in the unsweetened cocoa and chopped almonds. Divide the batter evenly between pans and tap each pan once on the counter to release large air pockets.
5. Bake until the centers spring back lightly and a tester comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs, 25 to 35 minutes. Cool 10 minutes in the pans, then turn out onto racks.
6. Cool completely before filling and frosting with the chocolate buttercream. Chill the assembled cake for 20 minutes before slicing for cleaner layers.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Brown Butter Chocolate Chip Cookies

*Chewy cookies with nutty brown butter, dark chocolate, and flaky salt.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-35 min

**SERVES**  
16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup browned unsalted butter
- 1 cup brown sugar and granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups dark chocolate chunks

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the browned unsalted butter and brown sugar and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and vanilla extract until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the dark chocolate chunks. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Oatmeal Raisin Cookies

*Soft-centered oat cookies with cinnamon, raisins, brown sugar, and walnuts.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour and rolled oats
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon and vanilla
- 1 1/2 cups raisins and chopped walnuts

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened butter and brown sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and ground cinnamon and vanilla until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the raisins and chopped walnuts. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Peanut Butter Cookies

*Rich peanut butter cookies with crisp edges, soft centers, and a classic crosshatch.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened butter and peanut butter
- 1 cup brown sugar and granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups chopped roasted peanuts

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened butter and peanut butter and brown sugar and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and vanilla extract until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the chopped roasted peanuts. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into small balls flattened with a fork with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# White Chocolate Macadamia Cookies

*Buttery cookies with vanilla, white chocolate, and toasted macadamia nuts.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened unsalted butter
- 1 cup brown sugar and granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups white chocolate chips and chopped macadamias

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened unsalted butter and brown sugar and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and vanilla extract until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the white chocolate chips and chopped macadamias. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cinnamon White Chocolate Cookies

*Soft cinnamon cookies with vanilla and white chocolate pieces.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened butter
- 1 cup brown sugar and granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp cinnamon and vanilla
- 1 1/2 cups white chocolate chips

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened butter and brown sugar and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and cinnamon and vanilla until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the white chocolate chips. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Fudgy Brownie Cookies

*Dense chocolate cookies with cocoa, melted chocolate, and dark chocolate chips.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour and cocoa
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened butter
- 1 cup brown sugar and granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups dark chocolate chips

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened butter and brown sugar and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and vanilla extract until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the dark chocolate chips. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Salted Caramel Cookies

*Buttery brown-sugar cookies with caramel pieces and a light flaky-salt finish.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups soft caramel pieces

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened butter and brown sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and vanilla extract until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the soft caramel pieces. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lemon Sugar Cookies

*Bright lemon cookies with vanilla, zest, and a crisp sugar edge.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup softened butter
- 1 cup granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp lemon zest and vanilla
- 1 1/2 cups coarse sugar and white chocolate chips

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the softened butter and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and lemon zest and vanilla until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the coarse sugar and white chocolate chips. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into rounded scoops with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Almond Orange Biscotti

*Twice-baked cookies with almonds, orange zest, vanilla, and crisp edges.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup melted butter
- 1 cup granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp orange zest and vanilla
- 1 1/2 cups toasted almonds

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the melted butter and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and orange zest and vanilla until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the toasted almonds. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into two logs sliced into fingers with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Coconut Macaroons

*Chewy coconut cookies with crisp golden edges and optional dark chocolate.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-35 min

**SERVES**

16-24 pieces

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/4 cups all-purpose flour or almond flour
- 1 tsp baking soda or 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup melted butter
- 1 cup granulated sugar
- 1 large egg plus 1 yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups sweetened shredded coconut and dark chocolate drizzle

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Store airtight 3 to 5 days or freeze baked cookies up to 2 months.
- Swap: Chill soft cookie dough before baking if cookies spread too much.
- Cook's tip: Pull cookies when centers still look slightly soft; carryover heat finishes them on the pan.

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350 F and line two baking sheets with parchment. Whisk the flour, leavening, and salt together.
2. Beat the melted butter and granulated sugar until smooth and slightly fluffy. Beat in the egg, yolk, and vanilla extract until glossy.
3. Fold in the dry ingredients just until combined, then mix in the sweetened shredded coconut and dark chocolate drizzle. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes if the dough is very soft.
4. Portion into compact mounds with space between each piece. For evenly baked cookies, make all portions close to the same size.
5. Bake until the edges are set and lightly browned but the centers still look slightly soft, 9 to 14 minutes depending on size.
6. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack. The cookies finish setting from residual heat, so avoid overbaking in the oven.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Classic Vanilla Pudding

*Silky vanilla pudding with milk, egg yolks, butter, and a clean vanilla finish.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**

6-8

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup vanilla wafer crumbs, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp vanilla bean paste
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup fresh berries
- 1 tbsp butter

### NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the vanilla wafer crumbs. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the granulated sugar, salt, and vanilla bean paste over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the vanilla wafer crumbs as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the fresh berries just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

### SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Dark Chocolate Pudding

*Rich cocoa and dark chocolate pudding with whipped cream and chocolate shavings.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**  
6-8

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup dark chocolate pieces, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp cocoa powder and vanilla
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup soft whipped cream
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the dark chocolate pieces. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the brown sugar, salt, and cocoa powder and vanilla over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the dark chocolate pieces as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the soft whipped cream just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Salted Butterscotch Pudding

*Deep brown-sugar pudding with butter, vanilla, and a small pinch of sea salt.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**

6-8

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup butterscotch chips or caramelized brown sugar, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup dark brown sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup toasted pecans
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the butterscotch chips or caramelized brown sugar. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the dark brown sugar, salt, and vanilla extract over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the butterscotch chips or caramelized brown sugar as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the toasted pecans just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Coconut Cardamom Pudding

*Creamy coconut pudding perfumed with cardamom and topped with toasted coconut.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**  
6-8

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup toasted coconut flakes, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups coconut milk and whole milk
- 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp ground cardamom and vanilla
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup fresh mango
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the toasted coconut flakes. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the coconut milk and whole milk, about half of the granulated sugar, salt, and ground cardamom and vanilla over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the toasted coconut flakes as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the fresh mango just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Lemon Custard Cups

*Bright lemon custard with vanilla, a smooth spoonable texture, and fresh berries.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**

6-8

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup lemon zest and juice, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp lemon and vanilla
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup blueberries
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the lemon zest and juice. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the granulated sugar, salt, and lemon and vanilla over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the lemon zest and juice as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the blueberries just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Coffee Cream Pudding

*Coffee-forward pudding with espresso, vanilla, cream, and cocoa dust.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**

6-8

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup espresso-soaked cake crumbs, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups milk and cream
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp espresso powder and vanilla
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup cocoa powder
- 1 tbsp butter

### NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the espresso-soaked cake crumbs. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the milk and cream, about half of the brown sugar, salt, and espresso powder and vanilla over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the espresso-soaked cake crumbs as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the cocoa powder just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

### SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cinnamon Rice Pudding

*Creamy rice pudding with cinnamon, vanilla, raisins, and toasted almonds.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**  
6-8

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup cooked short-grain rice, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp cinnamon and vanilla
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup raisins and toasted almonds
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the cooked short-grain rice. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the brown sugar, salt, and cinnamon and vanilla over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the cooked short-grain rice as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the raisins and toasted almonds just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Pistachio Rose Pudding

*Delicate pudding with pistachio, rose water, vanilla, and chopped nuts.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**

6-8

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup finely ground pistachios, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp rose water and vanilla
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup chopped pistachios
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the finely ground pistachios. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the granulated sugar, salt, and rose water and vanilla over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the finely ground pistachios as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the chopped pistachios just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Caramel Banana Pudding

*Vanilla-caramel pudding layered with banana slices and crisp cookie crumbs.*

**PREP**  
15-25 min

**COOK**  
10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**  
6-8

**LEVEL**  
Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup sliced ripe bananas, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp vanilla and caramel extract
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup crushed vanilla cookies
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the sliced ripe bananas. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the whole milk, about half of the brown sugar, salt, and vanilla and caramel extract over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the sliced ripe bananas as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the crushed vanilla cookies just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Berry Cheesecake Pudding

*Cream-cheese pudding with vanilla, lemon, berry compote, and graham crumbs.*

**PREP**

15-25 min

**COOK**

10-20 min + chill

**SERVES**

6-8

**LEVEL**

Easy-Moderate

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup graham cracker crumbs, for mixing or layering as appropriate
- 3 cups milk and softened cream cheese
- 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp vanilla and lemon zest
- 3 large egg yolks plus 2 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup mixed berry compote
- 1 tbsp butter

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Refrigerate covered and use within 3 days.
- Swap: Flavor extracts, citrus zest, spices, or toppings can be varied without changing the basic thickening method.
- Cook's tip: Cook custards and puddings over moderate heat and stir constantly to prevent scorching or curdling.

## METHOD

1. Prepare the graham cracker crumbs. If it is meant as a layer or garnish, set it aside; if it is chocolate, nuts, or another flavoring ingredient, have it ready to whisk into the hot pudding.
2. Warm the milk and softened cream cheese, about half of the granulated sugar, salt, and vanilla and lemon zest over medium-low heat until steaming but not boiling.
3. Whisk the egg yolks, cornstarch, and remaining sweetener in a bowl. Slowly whisk in about 1 cup of the hot dairy, then pour the tempered mixture back into the saucepan.
4. Cook over medium-low heat, whisking constantly, until the pudding bubbles gently and thickens enough to coat a spoon, 3 to 6 minutes. Remove from the heat and whisk in the butter.
5. Whisk in or layer with the graham cracker crumbs as appropriate. Spoon into serving dishes, cover the surface directly with plastic wrap or parchment, and chill until cold and set.
6. Finish with the mixed berry compote just before serving so the topping stays fresh or crisp.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Fresh Mint Lemonade

*Bright homemade lemonade with fresh mint and a balanced sweet-tart finish.*

**PREP**

5-15 min

**COOK**

0-10 min

**SERVES**

4

**LEVEL**

Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups fresh lemon juice and lemon slices
- 3 cups cold water
- 1/3 cup simple syrup or sugar
- 1/4 cup extra lemon juice
- 1 tsp fresh mint
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- mint sprigs and lemon wheels, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the fresh lemon juice and lemon slices, cold water, simple syrup or sugar, extra lemon juice, fresh mint, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the mint sprigs and lemon wheels. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Peach Iced Tea

*Black tea chilled with ripe peach, lemon, and light honey sweetness.*

**PREP**

5-15 min

**COOK**

0-10 min

**SERVES**

4

**LEVEL**

Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups sliced ripe peaches
- 3 cups strong brewed black tea
- 1/3 cup honey
- 1/4 cup lemon juice
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- peach slices and mint, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the sliced ripe peaches, strong brewed black tea, honey, lemon juice, vanilla extract, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the peach slices and mint. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Iced Spiced Mocha

*Chilled cocoa and coffee with dark chocolate, cinnamon, vanilla, and a pinch of chili.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups chopped dark chocolate and cocoa
- 3 cups cold coffee and milk or oat milk
- 1/3 cup brown sugar
- 1/4 cup coffee concentrate
- 1 tsp cinnamon and vanilla
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- whipped cream and cocoa, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the chopped dark chocolate and cocoa, cold coffee and milk or oat milk, brown sugar, coffee concentrate, cinnamon and vanilla, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the whipped cream and cocoa. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Mango Lassi

*Creamy mango-yogurt drink with cardamom, lime, and honey.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups ripe mango chunks
- 3 cups plain yogurt and cold water
- 1/3 cup honey
- 1/4 cup lime juice
- 1 tsp ground cardamom
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- mango cubes and mint, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the ripe mango chunks, plain yogurt and cold water, honey, lime juice, ground cardamom, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the mango cubes and mint. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Strawberry Banana Smoothie

*Thick fruit smoothie with yogurt, oats, vanilla, and optional nut butter.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups frozen strawberries and banana
- 3 cups milk or plant milk
- 1/3 cup honey
- 1/4 cup lemon juice
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- pinch of fine salt
- 3 cups ice or frozen fruit
- fresh strawberry slices, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the frozen strawberries and banana, milk or plant milk, honey, lemon juice, vanilla extract, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the fresh strawberry slices. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Iced Matcha Latte

*Smooth matcha with milk, vanilla, a little sweetener, and plenty of ice.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups matcha paste
- 3 cups cold milk or plant milk
- 1/3 cup maple syrup
- 1/4 cup a splash of water
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- light dusting of matcha, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the matcha paste, cold milk or plant milk, maple syrup, a splash of water, vanilla extract, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the light dusting of matcha. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Cinnamon Horchata

*Creamy rice drink with cinnamon, vanilla, milk, and a gentle sweetness.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups soaked rice and cinnamon
- 3 cups water and milk or plant milk
- 1/3 cup sugar
- 1/4 cup lime zest
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- ground cinnamon, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the soaked rice and cinnamon, water and milk or plant milk, sugar, lime zest, vanilla extract, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the ground cinnamon. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.



# Virgin Mojito

*Refreshing lime, mint, sparkling water, and cane sugar over crushed ice.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups fresh mint and lime wedges
- 3 cups sparkling water
- 1/3 cup cane sugar or simple syrup
- 1/4 cup fresh lime juice
- 1 tsp mint extract omitted; use extra fresh mint
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- mint sprigs and lime wheels, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the fresh mint and lime wedges, sparkling water, cane sugar or simple syrup, fresh lime juice, mint extract omitted; use extra fresh mint, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the mint sprigs and lime wheels. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Vanilla Coconut Cold Brew

*Cold brew with coconut milk, vanilla, a light brown-sugar sweetness, and toasted coconut.*

**PREP**

5-15 min

**COOK**

0-10 min

**SERVES**

4

**LEVEL**

Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cold brew coffee
- 3 cups coconut milk
- 1/3 cup brown sugar or maple syrup
- 1/4 cup a splash of water
- 1 tsp vanilla bean
- pinch of fine salt
- 1 cup ice
- toasted coconut and cocoa, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the cold brew coffee, coconut milk, brown sugar or maple syrup, a splash of water, vanilla bean, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the toasted coconut and cocoa. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.

# Mixed Berry Sorbet

*Smooth dairy-free sorbet with berries, lemon, sugar, and a pinch of salt.*

**PREP**  
5-15 min

**COOK**  
0-10 min

**SERVES**  
4

**LEVEL**  
Easy

## INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups frozen mixed berries
- 3 cups water
- 1/3 cup simple syrup
- 1/4 cup lemon juice
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- pinch of fine salt
- 3 cups ice or frozen fruit
- fresh berries and mint, for serving

## NOTES & SWAPS

- Storage: Chilled drink bases keep 2 days; frozen treats keep about 2 weeks tightly covered.
- Swap: Sweetness can be adjusted after tasting the cold mixture.
- Cook's tip: Cold suppresses sweetness and aroma, so season drinks slightly more boldly than room-temperature mixtures.

## METHOD

1. Combine the frozen mixed berries, water, simple syrup, lemon juice, vanilla extract, and salt in a blender or pitcher.
2. Blend or whisk until the sweetener is fully dissolved. Taste before adding all the ice because cold temperatures reduce perceived sweetness.
3. Adjust the balance with more acid for brightness, sweetener for roundness, or a little water if the flavor is too concentrated.
4. Add the ice and blend until smooth for a frozen drink, or stir gently for a chilled drink. Avoid overblending carbonated ingredients.
5. Pour into chilled glasses and add the fresh berries and mint. Serve immediately for the best aroma and texture.
6. For make-ahead preparation, mix the flavor base without ice and refrigerate; add ice or sparkling components only when serving.

## SERVING IDEA

Serve at the temperature the dish is designed for, then finish with a contrasting texture or fresh herb where useful. A simple salad, bread, rice, or seasonal vegetable can turn the recipe into a complete meal.